

RESEARCH METHODS

1(a) what is research

(b) The different classifications of research

(c) Different types of research (highlights)

(D) Importance of research

(e) Skills relevant to research e.g. identifying sources of research

(f) Sources of research i.e. primary sources, secondary sources Cite all authorities and other sources of information

Definition of research

Research in common practice refers to the search for knowledge.it can also be defined as a scientific and systematic search for pertinent information on a specific topic.

Dictionary defines research as a careful investigation or inquiry especially through search for new facts in any branch of knowledge. It's in fact a voyage of discovery.¹

¹ Research methodology methods and techniques by CR KOTHARI GAURAV GARG
3rd edition page 1

Research is an academic activity and as such the term should be used in a technical sense. According to Clifford, research comprises of defining and redefining problems, formulating hypothesis or suggested solutions; organising and evaluating data; making deductions and reaching conclusions; and at last carefully testing the conclusions to determine whether they fit the formulating hypothesis².

Research is thus an original contribution to the existing stock of knowledge making its advancement.³

The systematic approach concerning generalising and the formulation of a theory is also research.

Therefore as such, the term research refers to the systematic method consisting of enunciating the problem, formulating a hypothesis, collecting the facts or data, analysing the facts and reaching certain conclusions either in the form of solutions towards the concerned problem or in certain generalisations for some theoretical formulation.⁴

Classifications of research

From the view of existing books, it is evident that different authors have classified research in different ways. For example Gay classified research methods by analysis and purpose. Borg and Gall classified research mainly by the method of data collection.⁵

There are different reviews on the classifications of research as stated below;

1. Classification by purpose
2. Classification by methods of analysis
3. Classification by type of research
4. Classification by logic

1. Classification by purpose

² D. Slesinger and M. Stephenson in the Encyclopaedia

³ Wikipedia

⁴ Research methodology by Ranjit Kumar 3rd edition page 5

⁵ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page 155



Basic research also called pure or fundamental research, focuses on basic researchers are interested in deriving scientific knowledge, that is, of related problems can be deduced.⁶

The primary concern of basic research is therefore to add to the universe of scientific knowledge.

A basic research is normally motivated by intellectual curiosity and need to come up with a particular solution.

In basic research, there is no consideration of the practical application of the findings to actual problems or situations.

In the field of education, basic research is concerned with theory development and refinement in understanding the underlying process involved in learning school and other educational phenomena.⁷⁸

2. Applied research

Applied research is conducted for the purpose of applying or testing theory and evaluating its usefulness in solving problems.

It provides data to support theory, guide theory revision, or suggest the development of new theory.

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3. Action research

This is conducted with the primary intention of solving the specific, immediate and concrete problem in a local setting.

For example, a researcher could investigate ways of overcoming water shortage in a geographical area.⁹

⁶ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page 156

⁷ Ibid page 156

⁸ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page 157

⁹ Ibid page 157



4. Evaluation research

Gay defines evaluation research as the systematic process of collecting and analysing data in order to make decision.

Evaluation research is therefore a process of determining whether the intended results were realised.¹⁰

Classification by methods of analysis

1. Qualitative research

It is where findings cannot be expressed numerically, its instead the use of words, tests and pictures.

It aims at providing quality information other than quantitative.

Qualitative research is undertaken when we want to study perceptions, attitudes, and feelings.

Qualitative research is also carried out where there is no much information about the phenomenon/something under the study¹¹

2. Quantitative research.

- It is the one that can be experienced numerically.
- It aims at testing the relationship between variables.
- Statistics, figures and numbers can be used to present research findings.
- It is also used to test hypothesis.¹²
- One of the types of research under analysis is descriptive research.
- **Gay** defined descriptive research as a process of collecting data in order to test hypotheses or to answer questions concerning the current status of the subjects in the study.¹³

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- ¹⁰ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page 159
¹¹ Research methodology by Ranjit kumar page 14 4th edition
¹² Ibid page 14
¹³ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page 160



- Descriptive research determines and reports the way things are. This type of research attempts to describe such things as possible behaviour, attitudes, values, and characteristics.

Steps involved in descriptive research

- Formulating the objectives of a study
- Designing the methods of data collection
- Selecting the sample
- Data collection
- Analysing the results¹⁴

Casual-comparative research

Casual-comparative is used to explore relationships between variables.

The main purpose of casual-comparative research is therefore to determine reasons or causes for the current status of the phenomenon under study.

Casual comparative and experimental research

The main difference between casual-comparative researches is that in experimental research the researcher is able to manipulate one or more variable to determine their effect on another variable. **For example** a researcher may manipulate heat in a greenhouse to determine the effect of temperatures on the growth of seedlings.in casual-comparative research, the variable of interest cannot be manipulated.

This approach is sometimes called Ex-post facto research because causes are studied after they have existed their effect on another variable.¹⁵

Correlative methods

The correlative methods describe in quantitative terms the degree to which variables are related.

¹⁴ Ibid page 160

¹⁵ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page page 161



Correlative research involves collecting data in order to determine whether and to what degree a relationship exists between two or more quantifiable variables.¹⁶

Steps in correlational research

- Problem statement
- Selection of subjects
- Data collection
- Data analysis

Importance of research

The main purpose of research is to **discover new knowledge**. This involves the discovery of new facts, their correct interpretation and practical application. Although there are sources of knowledge, research remains the most efficient and reliable source of knowledge thus research helps one to find the truth and securing useful knowledge.¹⁷

The second purpose of research is to **describe a phenomenon**. Accurate identification of any event involves thorough description for example of size, shape, age, weight, colour, height, and change over time etc.

Research **enables description**. Prediction is the ability to estimate phenomenon A, given phenomenon B.

¹⁶ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page 163

¹⁷ Research methodology step by step guide for beginners page 176



For example, our knowledge about the relative movement of the moon, earth and sun helps us predict with amazing accuracy the occurrence of lunar eclipses. We sometimes use a set of variables to predict a given variable.

To enable theory development.

Theory development involves formulating concepts, laws and generalisations about a given phenomenon. Research helps in confirming or validating existing facts. Thus is sometimes referred to as “falsification of theory.”¹⁸

Research gives the latest information.

It enables one to find the most recent information available in certain fields especially scientific one, there is always new information and discoveries being made. Hence staying updated prevents one from falling behind and giving into that's inaccurate or doesn't paint the whole picture. With the latest information, one will be better equipped to talk about a subject and build on ideas.¹⁹

Research builds your credibility.

People will take what you have to say more seriously when they can tell you are informed. Doing research gives you a solid foundation on which you can build your ideas and opinions.

You can speak with confidence about what you know is accurate. When you have done the research, its much harder for someone to poke holes in what you are saying. Your research should be focused on the best sources.

Research helps in problem solving.

Whether its personal or professional, it helps to look outside yourself for help. Therefore research helps to make informed plans and make informed decisions.²⁰

¹⁸ Ibid page 169

¹⁹ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page page 1

²⁰ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page page 2



Research encourages curiosity.

Having curiosity and a love of learning takes you far in life. research opens you up to different opinions and new ideas. Hence it also builds discerning and analytical skills.

Skills relevant to research.

Goal setting.

Before you can carry out any type of effective research, you must know that it is what you are looking for. Goal setting is a skill like any other. If you are able to visualise the outcome you are trying to achieve by putting effort into research, it will make it that much easier to form a path there.²¹

Critical thinking. This should help you to interpret evidence And be able to identify the significance to your assignment question. It's a key skill that should be applied to all aspects of your study.²²

Research and critical thinking skills combine the abilities to identify credible data sources, gather and evaluate information, often following a clear methodology and based upon agreed objectives, analysing results and presenting an argument and insights based on the analysis.²³

Analytical thinking. Being able to objectively analyse an issue or problem and critically appraise different aspects or solution. This includes being able to reason well, define and review the work of the other, apply theories or abstract concepts and explain your thinking methodically to others.

Time management. Strong time management skills mean that you can organise a plan for how to break down larger tasks in a project and complete them by a deadline. Developing your time management skills can greatly improve the productivity of your research.

Respecting peoples research

A good researcher is able to distinguish their materials

²¹ Ibid pages 1 and 2

²² Research methodology methods and techniques 3rd edition page 4 by CR KOTHARI
GAURAV GARG

²³²³ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page 84



A good researcher should not be biased

A good researcher **should have a research plan**. The more specific and cleared, one becomes better as everything follows the research process. The main function of planning is to decide what one wants to find out about. The financial resources at one's disposal, the time available and one's research supervisor's expertise and knowledge in the field of study.

Sources of research

A primary source is a first-hand or contemporary account of an event or topic. They are the most direct evidence of a time or event because they were created by people or things that were there at the time or event. These sources have not been modified by interpretation and offer original thought or new information. Primary sources are original materials, regardless of format.

A primary source is anything that gives you direct evidence about the people, events, or phenomena that you are researching. Primary sources will usually be the main objects of your analysis.²⁴

Letters, laws, diaries, judgments, International conventions, government documents, dissertations, poems, minutes, speeches, letters, photographs, artefacts, personal narrative, diaries, interviews, original artwork, interviews, questionnaires, and sound or video recordings are examples of primary sources created as a time or event is occurring. Oral histories, newspaper or journal articles, and memoirs or autobiographies are examples of primary sources created after the event or time in question but offering first-hand accounts.²⁵

A secondary source:

Is anything that describes, interprets, evaluates, or analyses information from primary sources.

They tend to be works which summarise, interpret, recognise or otherwise provide an added value to a primary source²⁶

²⁴ Research methods by olive m mugenda PHD at page 167

²⁵ Research method the basics by Nicholas williman at page 92

²⁶ Supra on page 167



Common examples include:

- **Books, articles and documentaries** that synthesize information on a topic
- **Synopses and descriptions** of artistic works
- **Encyclopaedias and textbooks** that summarize information and ideas
- **Reviews of laws and legislation and essays** that evaluate or interpret something

In conclusion, we have discovered that research covers a wide range of thinking and covers all aspects of life and that it is of paramount reasons that all fields that carry out research use the techniques that serve their best interests. Specifically pointing to our points of discussion is that research methods and the methodologies serve different meanings and all the above fall in different classifications of research that will be discussed by group two members.

1. What is legal research?
2. What are the difference types of legal research?
3. What are the differences and similarities between legal research and non legal research/other research?
4. What is the relevance of legal research?
5. What are the sources of legal research?

Definition: Legal research is defined as the finding and assembling of authorities that bear on a question of law. This means that it's a process you use to identify and find the laws including statutes, regulations and court opinions that apply to the facts of your case.²⁷

Legal research can also be defined as a systematic finding of law on a particular point and making advancement in the science of law. Systematic involves legal materials, statutory, subsidiary and judicial pronouncements.

Legal research is the process of identifying and retrieving information necessary to

support legal decision making it includes each step of a course of action that begins with an analysis of the facts of the problem and concludes with the application and communication of the results of the

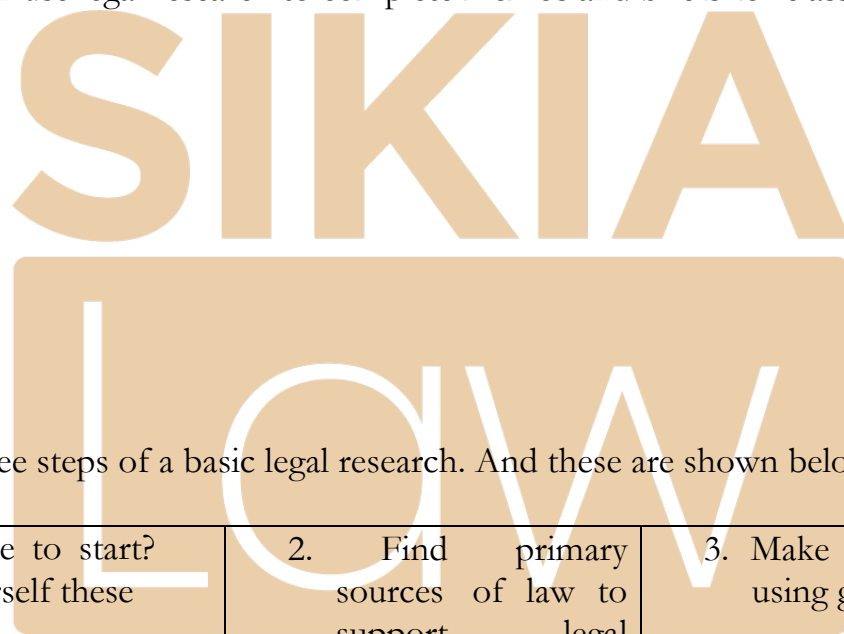
²⁷ Black's law dictionary 9th edition



investigation. The processes of legal research vary according to the country and the legal system involved. It involves tasks such as, finding primary sources of law, or primary authority in a given jurisdiction(cases, statutes, regulation), searching secondary authority from back ground information about a legal topic secondary authorities can come in many forms e.g. law review, legal dictionary, legal treatises and legal encyclopedias such as American Jurisprudence.²⁸

The purpose of legal research is to find support for a specific legal issue or decision. E.g. attorneys must conduct legal research if they need court opinions to back up a legal argument they are making in a motion or brief filed with the court.

Lawyers may need legal research to provide client with accurate legal guidance. Law students often use legal research to complete memos and briefs for class.



There are three steps of a basic legal research. And these are shown below;

1. Where to start? Ask yourself these	2. Find primary sources of law to support legal argument.	3. Make sure you are using good law.
What are the facts? ➤ Gather the key facts and write everything down	Secondary sources ❖ Start with secondary sources since they have already done the work for you and they cite the primary sources of law you can use. Examples include practice guides and legal articles and journals.	Use a citator like key cites to check your primary law. Key cite tells you if your law is still good i.e. Overruled, reversed or questioned.

What is the legal issue?	Primary sources	
❖ If you don't identify your action legal issue, you will	❖ These include case law, statutes and regulations	

²⁸Barkan steven, M.Binitliff, Barbara; Whisner Mary fundamentals of legal research 10th research[2018]



not know what to search about		
What is the jurisdiction? ❖ Focus your research on the relevant jurisdiction.		

Models of legal research

Well, legal research is done like any other research, however, there are certain models that distinguish it from the rest.

1. Evaluative

This is when a legal researcher wants to find out how a legal fact, rule, concept, an institution or the legal system itself comes to be what it is today. In other words the researcher attempts to trace the origin and development of a legal fact.

Such legal research can also be done to trace the development of constitutional law of a country. This is to ascertain the nature, scope and source of law in order to explain what the law is, and to spell out several propositions used in the law.

2. Indemnificatory and impact studies

Here a legal researcher seeks to ascertain the beneficiaries of a particular law or legal provision.

The question answered here is which are the parties expected to benefit by a given rule or system of law?

3. Projective and predictive

A legal researcher uses projective model of legal research when he wants to lay out the effects of a proposed legal measure. This is mainly done to anticipate the probable response.

According to C R Kothari, the basic types of research are;

Descriptive and Analytical research; descriptive as its name suggests describes the state of affairs as it exists at present. In the context of the law, the research is aimed at exploring what the existing law is on a given subject while in analytical research, the researcher uses his facts or information already available and makes their analysis to make a critical evaluation of the material. It merely



describes the phenomenon or situation under study and its characteristics. The methods commonly used in descriptive are survey methods of all kinds, including comparative and co-relational methods, and fact-finding enquiries of different kinds.

Applied and Fundamental Research; Applied research or action research aims at finding a solution for an immediate problem. Here the researcher sees his research in a practical context. While in fundamental/pure or basic research, the researcher is mainly concerned with generalization and with the formulation of a theory.

He undertakes research only to derive some increased knowledge in a field of his inquiry. He is least bothered about its practical context or utility. Research studies concerning human behavior carried on with a view to making generalizations about human behavior fall under fundamental or pure research.

But if the research (about human behavior) is carried out with a view to solving a problem (related to human behavior), it falls in the domain of applied or action research. The central aim of applied research is to discover a solution for some pressing practical problem, while that of fundamental research is to find additional information about a phenomenon and thereby to add to the existing body of scientific knowledge.

A sociologist, for example, when working with a social problem to find solution therefore and proposes, through a systematic inquiry, a solution or suggests some measures to ameliorate the problem, his research takes the label of 'applied' or 'action' research.

But when he undertakes a study just to find out the 'what', 'how' of the social problem, his inquiry takes the nomenclature of 'pure' or 'fundamental' research.

However, the above-mentioned 'distinguishing factor' between the 'applied' and 'fundamental' research need not be conceived as a 'line' putting the two 'across' the 'line' forever or an 'either or' dichotomy. In fact, they are not mutually exclusive. There is a constant interplay between the two, each contributing to the other in many ways.

Quantitative and Qualitative Research

Quantitative research is based on the measurement of quantity or amount. It is applicable to a phenomenon that can be expressed in terms of quantity. It is systematic scientific investigation of quantitative properties of a phenomenon and

their inter-relation. The objective of quantitative research is to develop and employ mathematical models, theories and hypotheses pertaining to the phenomenon under inquiry.

With grounded theory practice, it is research grounded in the observations or data from which it was developed. Various data sources used in grounded theory are quantitative data, review of records, interviews, observations, and surveys.



Narratology, it refers to the theory and study of narrative and narrative structure. It also shows the way in which the result affects the researcher's perception.

Storytelling, this is a method by which events are recounted in the form of a story. The method is generally used in the field of organization and management studies.

Ethnography, ethnography is used for investigating cultures by collecting and describing data intend to help the development of a theory.

Doctrinal research

A doctrinal research means a research that has been carried out on a legal proposition or propositions by way of analyzing the existing statutory provisions and cases by applying the reasoning power.

Doctrinal research has the root word “doctrine” which means a principle or a basic governing tenet. That means, the legal doctrine would include legal principles and tenets that would govern the legal world. Therefore, it implies that doctrinal legal research would involve digging deeper into the legal principles and concepts from various sources like cases, precedents, statutes and others; to analyze them and reach valid conclusions.

The focal point of doctrinal research is answering the question “What is law?”. It is library-based research, i.e. we try to find out definite answers to legal questions through a thorough investigation from the law books, statutes, legislation, commentaries and other legal documents. All of these sources fall under the category of “Secondary Sources”. As stated earlier, it is theoretical research that does not involve any kind of experimentation or fieldwork.

Here, we are basically checking the validity of existing laws in light of a changing society. It begins with one or more legal propositions taken as a starting point and the entire research is directed in finding the validity of that hypothesis. It simply means reviewing and studying different legal documents and other sources and then

deducing a complete answer to the question asked at the beginning by the means of rational interpretation and logical reasoning. Most often, the starting point in any research is doctrinal, i.e. library-based and then we move forward to other methodologies once our base is set by doctrinal research. This is the reason that doctrinal research is very famous among students and academicians.



Purpose

One of the main purposes of conducting doctrinal research is solving the legal problems of bringing laws. For example, if the government decides to bring umbrella legislation for all the crimes committed against women, it may initiate doctrinal research by some jurists and experts in the field.

They may have to go through all the existing laws in this field, previous case laws, precedents, international trends, legal commentaries, articles by scholars, dictionaries, encyclopedias, journals, treatises, textbooks and other sources of legal information. Going through this sea of information, they would be able to answer all the questions related to this legislation and will be successful in bringing out comprehensive legislation.

It can be utilized for several other purposes as well like to help lawmakers develop meaningful and effective laws, develop fresh legal doctrines, aid courts in reaching effective and legally accurate judgments, help lawyers to interpret statutes and prepare their suits, help students in academia to set a base and many others.

Methodology

The methodology in doctrinal research starts with setting a proposition as the starting point. A legal provision in question or an existing law could be chosen for the purpose. The next step could be to analyze the purpose behind bringing that particular law. For example, for a provision of the constitution, Constituent Assembly Debates could give great insight.

The law then can be studied in greater detail. A course of action must be selected. Alternative courses can be explored. Different models need to be studied and finally, the consequences and approximated effects have to be weighed in order to accurately make predictions about the proposition set at the beginning. In all these stages, secondary sources talked about in the above paragraphs are utilized.

But one must be very careful in the selection of these sources. Searching for reliable and accurate sources demands time and effort. Useful information must be separated from the chaff as the presence of unreliable information could lead to misleading and inaccurately skewed results. The



efficiency of this method also depends on the question that is asked in the beginning. Asking the right question is the first step towards concrete research. Setting the right proposition and then relying on the right sources is the key to successful doctrinal research.

Advantages and disadvantages

To begin with the advantages, doctrinal research forms the base of legal research in the academic field of law. Law students at the graduate and post-graduate levels usually venture into the world of legal research with the help of doctrinal methodology. This is the starting point for them where they can analyze sources available in the library and logically deduce their findings. The students are not well equipped at this particular stage to get involved with empirical research and to consider the law in the context of society. It is easier for them to study law “as it is” from secondary sources and it acts as a good starting point.

In addition, it gives the judges and lawyers the flexibility to approach law from different aspects and make its interpretation. It may not be wrong to say that the amorphous mass of the present- day statutory provisions takes concrete shape and form in the great laboratories of the law courts. (Jain 1982) Judges have over time developed law from their deep knowledge and investigation into the field. Law of torts is one great example as it is a “judge-made law”. Therefore, doctrinal research being the traditional methodology has helped in the development of legal research by giving it a base. It has been a close companion of law academicians, students, judges, advocates and jurists.

However, doctrinal research has its own shortcomings as well. Availability and choice of right and reliable sources is the bottleneck in doctrinal research. Logical deduction is also an uphill task. Furthermore, it is highly theoretical and restricted. Without the right direction, it may become highly objective and too mechanical. Moreover, it can

be further highlighted that it studies law individually and does not consider it in the backdrop of society which is the playground of law. Without studying its normative and practical aspects, it's like studying law in darkness and seems incomplete.

Non-doctrinal research



Meaning and definition

Non-doctrinal research, also known as social-legal research, is research that employs methods taken from other disciplines to generate empirical data that answers research questions. (Salim Ibrahim Ali 2017)

Non-doctrinal research takes a multi-disciplinary approach towards legal research. It employs methods and information available from other disciplines to make a comprehensive approach towards law. It employs primary sources of legal information to reach a conclusion. Primary sources may include observations, experiments, questionnaires, surveys, etc. With the help of these sources, we analyze the practical aspects of law like the effect of its implementation in non-legal fields and society as a whole. Basically, we take a legal variable which could be a law along with a non-legal variable like economic, social, political, etc. and study their relationship by data collected, which could be qualitative or quantitative. Its area of focus is how the law works in the real world.

Purpose and methodology

The purpose of non-doctrinal research is to check the utility of a law that has been brought or how it impacts the non-legal aspects of society. Also, non-legal factors affect the implementation of the law. Sometimes, a very comprehensive law is brought but sometimes the environment is such that its effectiveness is shielded by those circumstances. For example, a law brought to open the market for foreign players to liberalize the economy may be considered very destructive at a time like that of a pandemic when the domestic market is hard hit by lockdown and would be considered devastating.

While in normal circumstances the same law might have been proved very useful for the economy. Now research may be sponsored by the government to check whether circumstances are conducive to bringing such a law. The research may include

collecting data about the condition of the domestic market and how it will affect it if the law becomes a reality. Research after implementing the law can also be conducted to check its consequences and effects that it had actually brought. For this purpose, the help of other behavioral sciences can be taken. It relies on observation more than theory because under different circumstances theory remains the same but its practical



application changes and it is important to keep a track of these changes to keep the law updated and effective.

The methodology adopted is that of empirical research, i.e. different modes of experimentation and observation like collecting data by means of case studies, questionnaires, surveys, etc. These are the primary sources that give us first-hand information that can be then analyzed. This data collected can then be arranged in pie charts, bar graphs or other forms to reach a conclusion.

Advantages and disadvantages

The advantages of non-doctrinal research are many but the prime one remains its utility in practical purposes. It helps in gauging the practical effectiveness of laws in various non-legal fields. It is an effective tool to judge the performance of law in society. Legal issues are better analyzed when studied in a comprehensive manner by taking into consideration all the factors that might affect it. Moreover, when the data is quantified, it becomes rationally more appealing and authentic. Also, since it relies on primary sources of information, it is more reliable.

Developing welfare policies for people has become the major function of the state. But it is not possible without any data that reveals the actual circumstances of society. Non-doctrinal research tells us what actually the society needs, where the laws are lacking and what are the responses of people on whom those laws are imposed. All of this information which can be obtained by non-doctrinal research makes policymaking a better and easier task.

Moreover, there is a gap between the law in books and law in action. Law transforms to a certain extent when it comes to implementation. Many variables exert their influence to cause this transformation. Knowledge of these factors that can be obtained by non-doctrinal research can help us in understanding this gap and in working towards eliminating it.

However, it also has its fair share of pitfalls. Non-doctrinal research is very time-consuming. It requires a lot of time and resources. Availability of funds poses another challenge. The collection of data can be a daunting task. And more than that, collecting the right pool of information from society can be full of errors. People have different understanding and amounts of information. They have their own biases. That means the information collected, like from questionnaires and surveys can be skewed and misleading. Also, collecting primary data about some sensitive issues



can be a dangerous task for the researcher. The research may also be blurred by the researcher's personal prejudices and biases.

Comparison between doctrinal and non-doctrinal research

- Doctrinal research is theoretical research, while on the other hand, non-doctrinal research is more practical.
- Doctrinal research has its roots in the analytical or positivist school of thought. But non-doctrinal research comes from the realist school of thought.
- Doctrinal research is based on secondary sources of information, like articles, commentaries, textbooks, etc. But non-doctrinal research is based on primary sources like surveys and case studies.
- Non-doctrinal research includes fieldwork but doctrinal research is library-based arm-chair research that does not involve going to the field.
- Doctrinal research is more concerned with the question “What is law” and studying law exclusively. But non-doctrinal research studies law in connection with society and various non-legal aspects that affect the law. It is socio-legal research.
- The scope of doctrinal research is narrower concerning the law in isolation. But non-doctrinal research has a wider scope and studies law in comprehensive terms.
- Both forms of legal research have their own share of advantages and disadvantages. This means that none of them is infallible or complete in itself. One is rooted in theory while the other in practicality and as theory cannot be sacrificed for practicality alone and vice versa, both of them have their separate roles in the field of legal research.

Doctrinal research has helped in developing a basic awareness of legal issues among the people. It has immensely helped judges and attorneys in legal suits to develop valid arguments and reach an effective judgment. The development of tort law is a

prime example. Doctrinal research by focusing on “law as it is” has helped in percolating a greater awareness about legal issues among the masses. It has also helped in pointing out the loopholes in existing laws and statutes. As another side of the same coin, non-doctrinal research focuses on law in action in its playing field i.e. the society. It could be of great help for analyzing the effects of laws on people and how to bring out



legal reforms. It helps the law to catch up with this ever-changing society. Judicial activism is a great product of non-doctrinal research.

Therefore, both these forms are complementary to each other. Doctrinal research forms the foundation, on which the structure of non-doctrinal research can be constructed. They need to and must support each other. They can be used alternatively or in a hybrid form for effective and meaningful legal research.

Relevance.

Legal research provides teaching materials for students. It helps to understand and realize legal doctrine, principles of law, legal analysis to a law student.

Legal research is the essential and necessary tool for individual lawyers (advocates) and firms during their practice. It helps in the essential research of the case.

Legal research helps to look at doctrinal or theoretical issues. This helps to advice, direct Justices, Judges, Magistrates about the diligence of the legitimate philosophy to particular cases, affair so rot her legal activities.

Legal research helps to examine the law by reducing, breaking and separating the law into separate elements which makes it easy to interpret with ease.

Legal authorities / material used in legal research. These are into primary and secondary.

1. The primary authority is a term used to describe the rules of law.

They include the constitution, legislations, courts opinions, regulations and rulings of administrative agencies and other similar agencies that carry the force of law. These sources may be subject to changes overtime requiring supplementation and updating.

PRIMARY SOURCES

Primary Authority



Primary authority is "authority that issues directly from a law-making body." *Authority*,

²⁹Black's Law Dictionary 11th edition. Sources of primary authority include:

Constitutions

Constitutions are created at constitutional conventions. Delegates to these conventions work together to create a new constitution, which is then approved by the public.

Statutes

Statutes are the formal written law passed by a legislative body. Before a law is enacted, it begins as a bill in the legislature. A bill can begin in either house of the legislature, but must pass both to become law. It also must be approved or rejected by the executive (the U.S. President for federal laws and the state governor for state laws). A rejection is called a veto. To approve the law, the executive must sign it. However, if he or she does not sign it, it is not rejected. After 10 days have passed, if the executive has not vetoed the law, it becomes law without his or her signature. If the executive vetoes the law, it is not doomed. The executive must return the law to the legislature with his or her reasons for objecting to it. If the law passes both houses again with a 2/3 approval in each, it becomes law despite the veto.

Cases

A case is a dispute between two or more parties that is resolved by a court. The parties can be individual people or groups of people, the government, or incorporated entities. Cases can be either civil or criminal and are brought in both state and federal courts, but only the government can initiate a criminal case. Cases begin at the trial court level (also called the district court). If one of the parties disagrees with the decision, the party can appeal its case. Appellate courts, and sometimes trial courts, issue written decisions, which are often available online for free.

One of the roles of the courts is to interpret and apply statutes and constitutions. A court can also strike down statutes it believes to be unconstitutional. Sometimes, the legislative body may take the opinion of the court and use it to help re-work a new statute that will "pass constitutional muster." Additionally, if a court says a law is too vague to be applied in a particular case, the

²⁹ Black's Law Dictionary 11th edition



legislative body may go back and re-write the law to make it more specific. There is a back-and-forth to the process, but in the end, it is all part of our system of "checks and balances."

Regulations

Regulations, also called "administrative law," are sometimes confused with statutes but they are very different. Regulations are issued by administrative agencies, which are part of the executive branch of government. That means that regulations are not decided by people who are elected by the public, but rather, people who are appointed by the president or governor. But there are rules that require regulations to go through a public notice-and-comment period before they become final. Regulations are issued pursuant to a statutory authority, that is, a statute was passed that directed an administrative agency to develop regulations that will elaborate upon the statute. But regulations are very useful because they often get down to the nitty-gritty details of carrying out the directives laid out in statutes. Regulations are primary law but they are not equal in weight to statutes or cases. A statute can override a regulation or a court may decide that an agency didn't have the authority to pass a regulation.

Other sources.

Other than the four main primary sources of law, there are a few other sources that have varying degrees of enforcement and power. Executive materials include executive orders, which are orders by the president or governor to an administrative agency, have the full binding force of law.

2. Secondary.

These furnish the information derived from the primary authority. They are the writings of legal scholars, describing, interpreting, analyzing, summarizing and criticizing the law. These sources include the textbooks, commentaries on statutes, treatises, abstracts, bibliographies, dictionaries, encyclopedias, indexes, reviews and

thesaurus. These help in comprehending basic principles of and judicial statements on the topic under inquiry.

Abstracts are brief statements of the contents of research articles published in periodicals without approval. They provide a simplified key to find relevant studies from the vast literature on the subject.



Bibliographies list books and related materials on a particular subject. They contain the author's name, title, place of publication, publisher and the year of publication, publisher and the year of publication. So basically a bibliography provides a brief analysis of the contents.

Dictionary contains an alphabetical listing of words with their meaning, spelling, pronunciation, derivation and grammatical usage. Due to the growth of knowledge, the dictionary has not kept up with the technical terms developed in the various field which why so many other dictionaries have been published. In this case the black's law dictionary which is frequently used and referred to.

Encyclopedia is a book of information in the form of condensed articles on every subject. It provides meaning and historical background of concepts, important theories, names and references of major words.

Indexes are alphabetical listing of subjects and authors of literature included there in. an index is a detailed list of names, terms, subjects, places or other significant items in a complete work with exact page or other reference to material included in the work. So it helps to quickly recall or retrieve most relevant information and thereby to establish a contact between producer of idea or information.

A **review** is an integrated and organized discussion of the literature pertaining to a well defined subject. It usually covers a limited period of time.

A **thesaurus** is a book of words grouped by ideas. Its basic purpose is to help identify synonymous and find the exact word. Roget's Thesaurus accomplishes this task for the English language.

The reason the documents a classified into primary and secondary is to guide a researcher in citing such documents.

It is important to note that, **Statutes and case laws** rank paripassu authority or

weight. Any of them can be cited first. In practice, many cases are actually cited to illustrate, explain or interpret statutes.

METHODS AND METHODOLOGY



RESEARCH METHODS

The term **‘Research Methods’** refers to all those methods and techniques that are used by a researcher in conducting his research.

The term, thus, refers to the methods, techniques or tools employed by a researcher for collecting and processing of data, establishing the relationship between the data and unknown facts, and evaluating the accuracy of the results obtained.

Sometimes, it is used to designate the concepts and procedures employed in the analysis of data, howsoever collected, to arrive at conclusion. In other words, ‘research methods’ are the **‘tools and techniques’** in a ‘tool box’ that can be used for collection of data (or for gathering evidence) and analysis thereof. ‘Research methods’ therefore, can be put into the following three groups:

1. The **methods which are concerned with the collection of data** [when the data already available are not sufficient to arrive at the required solution].
2. The **statistical techniques** [which are used for establishing relationships between the data and the unknowns].
3. The **methods which are used to evaluate the accuracy of the results obtained.**

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The term **‘Research Methodology’**, on the other hand, refers to a ‘way to systematically solve’ the research problem.

It may be understood as a ‘science of studying how research is done scientifically’.

It involves a study of various steps and methods that a researcher needs generally to adopt in his investigation of a research problem along with the logic behind them.

It is a study of not only of methods but also of explanation and justification for using certain research methods and of the methods themselves.

Research methodology is the foundation which helps us to understand the determinants influencing the effectiveness of the methods applied.



In other words, research methodology is a set of rules of procedures about the way of conducting research. It includes in it not just a compilation of various research methods but also the rules for their application (in a given situation) and validity (for the research problem at hand).

A researcher, therefore, is required to know not only the research methods or techniques but also the methodology, as he needs to decide as well as to understand the relevancy and efficacy of the research methods in pursuing the research problem at hand.

Thus research methodology considers research methods, logic behind the methods we use in the context of our research study and explains why we are using a particular method or technique and why we are not using others so that research results are capable of being evaluated either by the researcher himself or by others.

It also considers why a research study has been undertaken, how the research problem has been identified, in what way and why the hypothesis has been formulated, what data have been collected and what particular method has been adopted, why particular technique of analyzing data has been used and a lot of similar other questions.

A study of research methodology has the following advantages:

1. It inculcates in a researcher the ability to formulate his research problem in an intelligent manner.
2. It inculcates in the researcher objectivities perceiving his research problem and seeking solutions therefore.
3. It equips him to carry out his research undertaking in an efficient manner and in a better way.
4. It enables him to take rational decisions at every step of his research.
5. It enables him to design appropriate research technique(s) and to use it (them) in an intelligent and efficient manner.

6. It enhances his ability to analyze and interpret data with reasonable objectivity and confidence.
7. It enhances ability of the researcher and/or others to evaluate research findings objectively and use the research results in a confident way.
8. It entails a good research.



9. It enables him to find a satisfactory way of acquiring new knowledge.

Key differences between research methods and research methodology

Research methods is defined as the procedure or technique applied by the researcher to undertake research whereas research methodology is a system of methods used scientifically for solving the research problem.

Research methods entail behavior or tools employed in selecting and building a research technique. Centrally, research methodology implies the science of analyzing the manner in which research is conducted appropriately.

Whereas research methods is concerned with carrying out experiment, tests among others, research methodology is concerned with learning various techniques which can be employed in the performance of experiment or test.

Research methods intend to discover the solution to the problem at hand. In contrast, research methodology aspires to apply appropriate procedures with a view to ascertaining solutions.

METHODS OF DATA COLLECTION

1. QUESTIONNAIRES

This is a primary source of data collection used in getting the required information directly from the respondents. In this method of data collection, a number of typed or printed pre-determined questions are used for collecting data. It is usually mailed to the respondents with a request to respond the questions in the space provided thereof and send it back to the investigator³⁰.

The questions in a questionnaire may be open-ended, closed-ended, mixed or pictorial. Questionnaire may be structured or unstructured;

Structured (closed ended) questionnaire

This type of questionnaires contains the questions and alternative answers.

Advantages

³⁰ Prof (Dr) Khushal Vibhute & Filipos Aynalem; Legal Research Methods 2009



It gives the respondent freedom to reveal their opinion and attitude.

Demerits

The information generated is difficult to process and analyze.

Unstructured (open ended) questionnaires

In this type of questionnaire, respondents fill in the answers to the questions by themselves. The questionnaire is often sent out by post, permitting large samples to be reached with relatively little extra effort.

Advantages

The respondent can easily explain their answer and opinion to the question. Data collected is more informative.

Disadvantages

Respondent's answers may be irrelevant to the question asked.

Applicability of Questionnaires

Questionnaires are best applied in research investigations where the respondents are scattered in various areas or jurisdictions and would be costly to reach each of them in person.

Advantages of questionnaires.

1. Questionnaire method of data collection is quite popular and useful when information is to be sought from numerous respondents who are scattered in a vast area.
2. It is suitable in certain responses especially if they are confidential.
3. It puts less pressure on the respondents as there is flexibility for respondents over where and when to complete the questionnaire.
4. Data collected is often accurate

5. Answers can be rapidly got in a short duration especially if the target group are in various jurisdictions.
6. Questionnaire is easy to plan, construct and administer as it doesn't require much technical skill or knowledge.



7. Questionnaire can be used as a preliminary tool for conducting a depth study later on by any other method.

Disadvantages of questionnaires

1. There is a tendency of mis-interpretation of questions and since the researcher does not go to the field, there is nobody to clarify any technical terms.
2. There is the possibility of low return of the questionnaires.
3. It is difficult to use with people who don't know how to read and write.
4. Answers may be copied from peers and data collected would be defective.
5. Illegible handwriting of the respondent sometimes create many difficulties for the researcher to understand the responses.
6. There is the risk of incomplete entries as some of the respondents may leave out many questions altogether unanswered, making the questionnaire an incomplete one.

Advantages over other methods

- a) Compared to interview, questionnaires work out to be cheaper and quicker.
- b) Questionnaire is the best method to collect information of wide coverage compared to interview or observation.
- c) There is increased privacy if the research is about sensitive information like sexual or marital relationship, as the respondent's name will be kept anonymous.
- d) Compared to schedule, interview or observation, questionnaire method is regarded as cheap where the repetitive information has to be collected at regular interval.

Guidelines for preparing questionnaire

1. Keep the language simple.
2. Keep questions short. Long and complex questions are difficult to understand.

3. Avoid double-barreled questions. Such questions asking two questions at once.(e.g Is your key worker caring and supportive?).Split into separate questions.
4. Avoid leading questions. Leading questions encourage a particular answer.(e.g Do you agree that.)
5. Avoid questions in the negative. Negatively framed questions are difficult to understand; particularly when you are asked to agree or disagree.



6. Ask questions only where respondents are likely to have the knowledge needed to answer.
7. Try to ensure that the questions mean the same thing to all respondents. Meanings and terms used may vary for different age groups, regions, etc.
8. Avoid a prestige bias- This occurs when a view is linked with a prestigious person before asking the respondent's view.
9. Ensure that the question's frame of reference is clear. When asking for frequency of an event, specify the time period.
10. Avoid creating opinions. Respondents do not necessarily hold opinions on topics. Allow a no opinion alternative

FOCUS GROUP DISCUSSION

Focus group discussion is a qualitative research method and data collection technique in which a selected group of people discuss a given topic or issue in depth facilitated by a professional external moderator.

This means the researcher assembles a group of individuals to discuss a specific topic aiming to draw from their complex personal experience, beliefs, perceptions, attitudes of the participants through a moderated interaction³¹.

Focus group discussion is sometimes seen as synonymous with interviews especially the same structured one to one and group interviews. According to Parker and Tritler, the similarities between these techniques relate to the tendency to uncover people's perception and values.³² However they are different. Existing evidence shows that the role of the researcher and the relationship with the participants point to the fundamental difference.

In interviews, they involve a one to one qualitative and in depth discussion which the researcher adopts the role of an investigator. This implies that the researcher asks questions, controls the dynamics of the discussion or engages in dialogue with a

specific individual at a time. While under

³¹ Cornwall & Jewkes 1995

³² Parker & Tritler 2006



Focus group discussion, the researcher moderates a group discussion between participants and not between the researcher and the participants.

Applicability of FGD's

FGDs can be used to explore the meanings of survey findings that cannot be explained statistically, the range of opinions/views on a topic of interest and to collect a wide variety of local terms.

In bridging research and policy, FGD can be useful in providing an insight into different opinions among different parties involved in the change process, thus enabling the process to be managed more smoothly.

It is also a good method to employ prior to designing questionnaires.

FGD allows the participants to agree or disagree with each other so that it provides an insight into how a group thinks about an issue, about the range of opinion and ideas, and the inconsistencies and variation that exists in a particular community in terms of beliefs and their experiences and practices.

Advantages

This method helps a researcher to generate a discussion or debate about a research topic that requires collective views and the meanings that lie behind those views including their experience and beliefs.

Researcher may use focus group discussion to explore a topic, obtain information or narratives for use in the later stages of research for example testing narratives and developing questionnaires.

According to Krueger and Morgan focus group discussion as a qualitative research method is comparatively easier to conduct since all the target participants and the researcher are readily available in one location at the same time. Geographic proximity is an important consideration for researchers with resource constraints in developing

nations.

FDG is flexible technique and is adaptable at any stage of research compared to more conventional techniques such as individual interviews and surveys, FDG offers an opportunity to explore issues that are not well understood or where there is little prior research on the topic.



The process of sharing and comparing understandings and views can yield more insights than the equivalent number of individual interview.

DISADVANTAGES

Participants are sometimes reluctant to deal with sensitive topics in a discussion setting compared with an individual interview or surveys.

In most cases the range of topics that participants feel comfortable discussing may not be what the researcher intends to explore.

The group sometimes is not conducted in a natural atmosphere or where the researcher is not located close to the study site. In most situations participants are collected in one location and are prepared in advance for the discussion around the topic rather than in their residence or work place

It is not recommended where there is a risk of raising participant's expectations that cannot be fulfilled or where strategic group biases are anticipated.

OBSERVATION METHOD

Observation as the name means away of collecting data through observing. This data collection method is classified as a participatory study because the researcher has to immerse herself in the setting where her respondents are while taking notes or recording. Observation, listening, reading, touching and recording behavior and characteristics of phenomenon.

Observation as a data collection method can be structured or unstructured.

- In structured or systematic observation, data collection is conducted using specific variables and according to a predefined schedule.
- Unstructured observation on the other hand is conducted in an open and free manner in a sense that there would be no predetermined variables or

objectives.

- Further data collection under observation can be divided into overt and covert categories.
- Under overt observation, research subjects are aware that they are being observed.



- In Covert observation on the other hand, the observer is concealed and sample group members are not aware that they are being observed.
- Covert observation is considered to be more effective because in this case sample group members are likely to behave naturally with positive implications on the authenticity of research findings.

SIKIA

There are various types of research by observation and mainly in four categories:

NATURALISTIC OBSERVATION

It is an observational method that involves observing people's behavior in the environment in which it typically occurs. The naturalistic observation is a type of field research (As opposed to the type of laboratory research). Jane Goodall's famous research on chimpanzees is a classic example of a naturalistic observation. Dr Goodall spent 3 decades observing chimpanzees in their natural environment in East Africa. She examined chimpanzees mating patterns, gender, family structure and care of off springs by observing them in the wild.

It can take disguised naturalistic observation where participants are not aware that they are being observed.

It can also be undisguised naturalistic observation where the participants are made aware of the presence of the researcher and monitoring their behavior.

PARTICIPANT OBSERVATION



Researchers become active participants in observation. The only rationale for participant observation is that there is important information that is only accessible to or can only be interpreted only by someone who is an active participant in the group or situation.

It can also be disguised or undisguised. In disguised participant observation, the researchers pretend to be members of the social group they are observing and conceal their true identity as researchers.

In comparison to undisguised participant observation, the researchers become part of the group they are studying and they disclose their true identity as researchers to the group under investigation.

For example

Rosenhan's study 1973 of the experience of people in a psychiatric ward would be considered disguised participant observation because Rosenhan and his pseudo patients were admitted into psychiatric hospitals on the pretense of being patients so that they could observe the way that psychiatric patients are treated by staff. The staff and other patients were unaware of their true identities as researchers.

Another example of participant observation comes from a study by sociologist Amy Wilkins (published in social psychology Quarterly) on a university based religious organization that emphasized how happy his members were (Wilkins 2008) Wilkins spent 12 months attending and participating in groups meetings and social events and she interviewed several group members. In her study, Wilkins identified several ways in which the group enforced happiness. For example by continually talking about happiness, discouraging the expression of negative emotions and using happiness as a way to distinguish themselves from other groups.

CASE STUDY

Is in a depth examination of an individual sometimes they are conducted on social units like in natural disasters. For example the case of HM is one of the most notorious case studies in psychology. HM suffered from intractable and severe epilepsy. A surgeon localizes HM's epilepsy to his medial temporal lobe and in 1953 removed large sections of his hippocampus in an attempt to stop the seizures. The treatment was a success but his epilepsy and his I.Q were unaffected. However doctors observed that he exhibited a strange form of amnesia, called anterograde



amnesia. HM was able to carry out a conversation and he could remember short strings of letters, digits. He lost the ability to transfer information from his short term memory to his long term memory. He was an important case study for memory.

It suggested that there is a disassociation between short term memory and long term memory. There are two different abilities sub served by different areas of the brain.

ARCHIVAL OBSERVATION

It is the observation of previous data that has been collected and analyzed often for another purpose.

Advantages and Disadvantages of observational methods

A. Advantages

Its major advantage as a technique is its directness. You do not ask people about their views, feelings or attitudes; you watch what they do and listen to what they say.

Observation also seems to be preeminently the appropriate technique for getting at 'real life' in

the real worlds direct observation. Direct observation in the field permits a lack of a artificiality which is all too rare with other techniques. For example, a judge in a court of law can use his observation in performing his daily judgeship tasks to do researches on the application of law on various issues.

B. DISADVANTAGES

Observation is neither an easy nor a trouble free option. There is a major issue concerning the extent to which an observer affects the situation under observation.

A practical problem with observation is that it tends to be time consuming. The classic participant observation study, deriving from social anthropology, for example, demands an immersion in the 'tribe' for two or three years. The same also seems true

as to the time required to do legal research by the observational methods, though it may not take yea

SURVEYS



Survey research enables information to be derived from sample on topic investigation to ascertain and measure the respondents' knowledge, attitudes, values, opinions, actions, intentions, behaviors and beliefs. It follows the quantitative approach, is considered non-experimental and requires data analysis to be conducted by interviews (face-to-face or by telephone) or questionnaires (postal or internet).

DEFINITION OF SURVEYS IN RESEARCH METHODS.

Survey research is defined as the process of conducting research using surveys that researchers send to survey respondents. The data collected from surveys is then statistically analyzed to draw meaningful research conclusions.

The traditional definition of surveys in research is a quantitative method of collecting information from a pool of respondents by asking multiple survey questions. This research type includes the recruitment of individuals, collection and analysis of data.

What are surveys used for/ applicability of surveys.

Surveys are used as a method of gathering data in many different fields. They are a good choice when you want to find out about the characteristics, preferences, opinions, or beliefs of a group of people.

Common uses of survey research include:

- Social research: investigating the experiences and characteristics of different social groups.
- Market research: finding out what customers think about products, services, and companies.
- Health research: collecting data from patients about symptoms and treatments.
- Politics: measuring public opinion about parties and policies.
- Psychology: researching personality traits, preferences and behaviours.

Advantages of Surveys Research over

others Cost

Surveys – particularly online surveys – have a very small cost per participant. Even with incentives, the cost per response is often far less than the cost of running a focus group or a phone interview, while the responses you receive can number into the thousands.



Data Collection

Data collection is much easier with surveys, which tend to use easy to read data sources that can be compiled and analyzed as needed for your market research needs. The [qualitative research techniques](#) of other market research methods may yield some interesting answers, but the ability to analyze themes becomes a much more difficult (and possibly inaccurate) process.

Sample Size

Sample size is one of the most underrated aspects of all types of research, including market research. Far too many companies make the mistake of assuming their small sample of only a few dozen participants is enough to make any firm conclusions. Surveys allow you to reach thousands of possible participants if necessary, which ensures a more accurate sample in which to draw conclusions.

Candid Responses

The [anonymity of surveys](#) allows people to feel more candid with their responses. To get accurate data, you need your participants to be as honest as possible with their answers. Surveys provide more honest responses than other types of research methodology, especially if it is clear that the answers will remain confidential.

Conclusion

Survey is the primary step towards obtaining quick information about mainstream and conducting more rigorous and detailed quantitative research methods like polls or qualitative research methods.

- 1. Interview as a research methodology**
- 2. Mixed methods of research.**
- 3. Primary and Secondary sources of information/data in research**

4. Everything about the same.
5. Definitions and descriptions.
6. Differences and similarities
7. Advantages and disadvantages.
8. Relevance.



INTRODUCTION;

The term '**research**' has received a number of varied meanings and explanations. In its ordinary sense, the term refers to a search for knowledge. The **Advanced Learner's Dictionary of Current English** spells out the meaning of 'research' as 'a careful investigation or inquiry specifically through search for new facts in any branch of knowledge'.³³

Redman and Mory, in a similar tone, define **research** as a 'systematized effort to gain new knowledge'.³⁴ According to the **Webster's International Dictionary**, 'research' is 'a careful, critical inquiry or explanation in seeking facts or principles; diligent investigation in order to ascertain something'. While **Webster Dictionary** explains the term 'research' to mean 'a systematic investigation towards increasing the sum of knowledge'.

The **1911 Cambridge edition of the Encyclopedia Britannica** defines research as: The act of searching into a matter closely and carefully, inquiry directed to the discovery of truth and in particular, the trained scientific investigation of the principles and facts of any subject, based on original and first hand study of authorities or experiment. Investigations of every kind which has been based on original sources of knowledge may be styled research and it may be said that without 'research' no authoritative works have been written, no scientific discoveries or inventions made, no theories of any value propounded.

There are **BASIC TOOLS OF DATA COLLECTION** under legal research and **these include**, Interview, Questionnaire and Observation

A). INTERVIEW

Interviewing, as a research method, typically involves you, as researcher, asking questions, and hopefully, receiving answers from the people you are interviewing. It is very widely used in social research including the legal research. There are many types

of interview.

Types and styles of interview

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- ³³ The Advanced Learner's Dictionary of Current English (Oxford, 1952) 1069
³⁴ L V Redman and A V H Mory, The Romance of Research (1923) 10.



The form of interviews may vary widely. A commonly made distinction is based on the degree of structure or standardization of interview. Interviews may range all the way from the rigidly standardized to a completely unstructured interview.

1. Fully structured interview- has predetermined questions with fixed wording, usually in a pre-set order. The use of mainly open-response questions is the only essential difference from an interview-based survey questionnaire.³⁵

2. Semi-structured interview- It has predetermined questions, but the order can be modified based upon the interviewer's perception of what seems most appropriate. Question wording can be changed and explanations given; particular questions which seem inappropriate with a particular interviewee can be omitted, or additional ones included.

3. Unstructured interviews- The interviewer has a general area of interest and concern, but lets the conversation develop within this area. It can be completely informal. Here, both the questions asked and responses given are left flexible and open. Semi structured and unstructured interviews are widely used in flexible, qualitative designs and they are referred as qualitative research interviews.

General advice for interviewers.

The interview is a kind of conversation, something that we all have had experience in doing. Your job, as interviewer, is to try to get interviewees to talk freely and openly. Your own behavior has a major influence on their willingness to do this. To this end, you should:

1. Listen more than you speak-Most interviewers talk too much. The interview is not a platform for the interviewer's personal experiences and opinions.

2. Put questions in a straight forward, clear and non-threatening way. If people are confused or defensive, you will not get the information you seek.³⁶

3. Eliminate cues which lead interviewees to respond in a particular way. Many interviewees will seek to please the interviewer by giving 'correct' responses

³⁵ Colin Robson, *Real World Research* (Blackwell Publishing, 2002, p.270

³⁶ S. K. Verma and M.Afzal Wani (eds), *Legal Research and Methodology* (Indian Law Institute, 2001), pp.367-371



4. Enjoy it (or at least look as though you do). Do not give the message that you are bored or scared. Vary your voice and facial expression. It is also essential that you take a full record of the interview. This can be from notes made at the time and/ or from a recording of the interview. Experienced interviewers tend to have strong preferences for one or other of these approaches.³⁷

Content of interview ;

In interviews which are to a greater or lesser extent pre-structured by the interviewer, the content, which can be prepared in advance, consists of:

- a set of items (usually questions) often with alternative subsequent items depending on the responses obtained;
- suggestions for so -called probes and prompts;
- and a proposed sequence for the questions which, in a semi-structured interview, may be subject to change during the course of the interview.

Probes- A probe is a device to get interviewees to expand on a response when you intuit that they have more to give. There are tactics, such as asking 'anything more?' or 'would you go over that again?' or using a period of silence, or an enquiring glance, etc³⁸

Prompts- They suggest to the interviewee the range or set of possible answers that the interviewer expects. The list of possibilities may be read out by the interviewer, or a 'prompt card' with them can be shown (e.g a list of names of alcoholic drinks for a question on drinking habits).³⁹

Questions to avoid in interviews:

In conducting interview the interviewer should avoid the following forms of questions.

- Long questions- The interviewee may remember only part of the question, and respond to that part.

- Double barreled (multiple-barreled) questions.

³⁷ Colin Robson, cited above.pp.273-274

³⁸ Id.p.274

³⁹ Id.pp.274-276



- Questions involving Jargon- Generally you should avoid questions containing words likely to be unfamiliar to the target audience.
- Leading questions-Modify such questions if you realize that they are leading in a particular direction.
- Biased questions- provided that you are alert to the possibility of bias, it is not difficult to write unbiased questions.⁴⁰

The sequence of questions;

A commonly used sequence is as follows:

1. Introduction- Interviewer introduces herself, explains purpose of the interview, assures of confidentiality, and asks permission to tape and / or make notes.⁴¹
2. 'Warm-up' - Easy, non -threatening questions at the beginning to settle down both of you
3. Main body of interview- covering the main purpose of the interview in what the interviewer considers being a logical progression.
4. 'Cool-off'-Usually a few straight forward questions at the end to defuse any tension that might have built up.
5. Closure- Thank you and goodbye. a. Interview may be conducted with face-to face interviewing, telephone interviewing and in this computerization age even through electronic (e-mail) communication.

Advantages and Disadvantages of Interviews;

1. The interview is a flexible and adaptable way of finding things out.

⁴⁰ Cited above at note 1, pp.227-259 and pp.354-363, Notes in this section are mainly taken from the two cited reference materials

⁴¹ Colin Robson, cited above, pp.245-246



2. Face to face interviews offer the possibility of modifying one's line of enquiry, following up responses and investigating underlying motives in a way that postal and self-administered questionnaires cannot. Non-verbal cues may give messages which help in understanding the verbal response, possibly changing or even, in extreme cases, reversing, its meaning.
3. Although interviewing is in no sense soft option as a data-gathering technique, it has the potential of providing rich and highly illuminating material.⁴²
4. Interviewing is time-consuming, and it could have the effect of reducing the number of persons willing to participate.⁴³
5. All interviews require careful preparation-making arrangements to visit, securing necessary permissions which take time; confirming arrangements, rescheduling appointments to cover absences and crises takes more time.

B). MIXED METHODS OF RESEARCH.

A mixed methods research design is a procedure for collecting, analyzing, and “mixing” both quantitative and qualitative research and methods in a single study to understand a research problem.

A mixed-methods approach is a research methodology in its own right. As stated by **Creswell and Plano Clark**⁴⁴ a mixed-methods research design is a research design that has its own philosophical assumptions and methods of inquiry.

As a methodology, it includes philosophical assumptions to provide directions for the collection and analysis of data from multiple sources in a single study.

A **mixed-methods** design offers a number of benefits to approaching complex research issues as it integrates philosophical frameworks of both post-positivism and interpretivism⁴⁵ interweaving qualitative and quantitative data in such a way that research issues are meaningfully explained. It

⁴² Colin Robson.pp.310-330, and S. K. Verma and M.Afzal Wani (eds),pp.333-353

⁴³ Id.p.277

⁴⁴ (2011),

⁴⁵ (Fetters, 2016)



also offers a logical ground, methodological flexibility and an in depth understanding of smaller cases⁴⁶

In other words, the use of mixed-methods enables researchers to answer research questions with sufficient depth and breadth⁴⁷ and helps generalize findings and implications of the researched issues to the whole population. For example, the quantitative approach helps a researcher to collect the data from a large number of participants; thus, increasing the possibility to generalize the findings to a wider population.

Why Mixed Methods?

Mixing two methods might be superior to a single method as it is likely to provide rich insights into the research phenomena that cannot be fully understood by using only qualitative or quantitative methods. A mixed-methods design can integrate and synergize multiple data sources which can assist to study complex problems⁴⁸

The application of MMR, as mentioned in the previous section, means purposeful data consolidation which allows researchers to seek a wide view of their study by enabling them to view a phenomenon from different perspectives and research lenses⁴⁹

There are six major justifications for combining quantitative and qualitative data in a research study. The first rationale of employing an MMR approach is the expansion of study. This means an MMR approach allows researchers widen their inquiry with sufficient depth and breadth. For instance, when a researcher wants to generalize the findings to a population and develop a detailed view of the meaning of a phenomenon or concept for individuals, the advantages of collecting both closed-ended quantitative data and open-ended qualitative data support understanding a research problem⁵⁰

Another driving motive for combining the two methods is the belief that both kinds of research have values and that in some respects they are complementary, and

therefore, there will be an

⁴⁶ (Maxwell, 2016).

⁴⁷ (Enosh, Tzafrir, & Stolovy, 2014)

⁴⁸ (Poth & Munce, 2020).

⁴⁹ (Shorten & Smith, 2017).

⁵⁰ (Creswell, 2003).



added value in combining them. The researchers use both data sets to answer the same research question which can produce greater certainty and wider implication in the conclusion⁵¹. In other words, mixing two methods helps to produce a more complete picture and provides an opportunity for a greater assortment of divergent or complementary views; which are valuable as they not only lead to extra reflection and enrich our understanding of a phenomenon, but also open new avenues for future inquiries.⁵²

Third, an MMR approach helps “to overcome the epistemological differences between quantitative and qualitative paradigms and to provide a royal road to true knowledge”⁵³. Indeed, a principled combination of the two methods supports researchers in developing an in-depth and comprehensive understanding of a research phenomenon⁵⁴. For example, while using a quantitative method, concepts can be operationalized in terms of well-defined indicators, tracing trends and relationships, making comparisons, and using large and perhaps representative samples, a qualitative method has the strengths of sensitivity to multiple meanings, logical ground, great methodological flexibility and in-depth study of smaller samples which helps to study the process and change.

Fourth, an MMR approach helps to obtain more rigorous conclusions by employing two methods in such a way that the strengths of the qualitative methods offset the weaknesses of the quantitative methods and vice versa⁵⁵. This implies that a quantitative method can be strong in those areas where a qualitative method is weak and vice versa. Putting it in another way, one method is more suitable to answer one type of question and another method is more suitable for another type of question.

Another value of an MMR approach is its triangulation component. Data triangulation in a mixed- methods study is generally accepted as a strategy for validating results obtained with the individual method⁵⁶. A researcher, for instance, aims to obtain a more valid picture about a research issue by directly comparing the

findings drawn from one

⁵¹ (Maxwell, 2016; Morgan, 2014)

⁵² (Teddle & Tashakkori, 2009).

⁵³ (Bergman, 2008, p. 4).

⁵⁴ (Lund, 2012).

⁵⁵ (Plano Clark & Ivankova, 2016).

⁵⁶ (Bergman, 2008).



method (qualitative or quantitative) to those obtained from another (quantitative or qualitative) for convergence and/or divergence.⁵⁷

Finally, the sixth rationale for mixing the two methods is “to develop more effective and refined conclusions by using the results from one method (qualitative or quantitative) to inform or shape the use of another method (qualitative or quantitative)”⁵⁸. For instance, researchers who want to understand possible factors that cause obesity in children might argue for the need to quantitatively assess significant predictors and then they use the quantitative results to develop qualitative follow-up exploration (potentially through interviews, observation, and focus groups) to explore why certain factors were significant.

Mixed methods research question examples;

To what extent does the frequency of traffic accidents (quantitative) reflect cyclist perceptions of road safety (qualitative) in Uganda?

How do student perceptions of their school environment (qualitative) relate to differences in test scores (quantitative)?

How do interviews about job satisfaction at Company X (qualitative) help explain year-over-year sales performance and other KPIs (quantitative)?

How can voter and non-voter beliefs about democracy (qualitative) help explain election turnout patterns (quantitative) in Town X?

How do average hospital salary measurements over time (quantitative) help to explain nurse testimonials about job satisfaction (qualitative)?

When to use mixed methods research

Mixed methods research may be the right choice if your research process suggests that

quantitative or qualitative data alone will not sufficiently answer your research question. There are several common reasons for using mixed methods research:

⁵⁷ (Plano Clark & Ivankova, 2016).

⁵⁸ (Plano Clark & Ivankova, 2016, p. 86)



Generalizability: Qualitative research usually has a smaller sample size, and thus is not generalizable. In mixed methods research, this comparative weakness is mitigated by the comparative strength of “large N,” externally valid quantitative research.

Contextualization: Mixing methods allows you to put findings in context and add richer detail to your conclusions. Using qualitative data to illustrate quantitative findings can help “put meat on the bones” of your analysis.

Credibility: Using different methods to collect data on the same subject can make your results more credible. If the qualitative and quantitative data converge, this strengthens the validity of your conclusions. This process is called triangulation.

As you formulate your research question, try to directly address how qualitative and quantitative methods will be combined in your study. If your research question can be sufficiently answered via standalone quantitative or qualitative analysis, a mixed methods approach may not be the right fit.

Mixed methods research designs

There are different types of mixed methods research designs. The differences between them relate to the aim of the research, the timing of the data collection, and the importance given to each data type.

- As you design your mixed methods study, also keep in mind:
- Your research approach (inductive vs deductive)
- Your research questions
- What kind of data is already available for you to use
- What kind of data you’re able to collect yourself.

Here are a few of the most common mixed methods designs.

Convergent parallel

In a convergent parallel design, you collect quantitative and qualitative data at the same time and analyze them separately. After both analyses are complete, compare your results to draw overall conclusions.



Example: Convergent parallel design

In your research on cycling safety in Uganda, you undertake both sides of your research simultaneously:

On the qualitative side, you analyze cyclist complaints via the city's database and on social media to find out which areas are perceived as dangerous and why.

On the quantitative side, you analyze accident reports in the city's database to find out how frequently accidents occur in different areas of the city.

When you finish your data collection and analysis, you then compare results and tie your findings together.

Embedded; In an embedded design, you collect and analyze both types of data at the same time, but within a larger quantitative or qualitative design. One type of data is secondary to the other.

This is a good approach to take if you have limited time or resources. You can use an embedded design to strengthen or supplement your conclusions from the primary type of research design.

Example: Embedded design

As part of a quantitative study testing whether the number of cyclist complaints about an area correlates with the number of accidents, you could “embed” a series of qualitative interviews with cyclists who submitted complaints to further strengthen your argument. The bulk of your research remains quantitative.

Explanatory sequential; In an explanatory sequential design, your quantitative data collection and analysis occurs first, followed by qualitative data collection and analysis.

You should use this design if you think your qualitative data will explain and contextualize your quantitative findings.

Example: Explanatory sequential

SIKIA
Low

You analyze the accident statistics first and draw preliminary conclusions about which areas are most dangerous. Based on these findings, you conduct interviews with cyclists in high-accident areas and analyze complaints qualitatively.

You can utilize the qualitative data to explain why accidents occur on specific roads, and take a deep dive into particular problem areas.

Exploratory sequential; In an exploratory sequential design, qualitative data collection and analysis occurs first, followed by quantitative data collection and analysis.

You can use this design to first explore initial questions and develop hypotheses. Then you can use the quantitative data to test or confirm your qualitative findings.

Example: Exploratory sequential design

You first interview cyclists to develop an initial understanding of problem areas, and draw preliminary conclusions. Then you analyze accident statistics to test whether cyclist perceptions line up with where accidents occur.

Advantages of mixed methods

research “Best of both worlds”

analysis;

Combining the two types of data means you benefit from both the detailed, contextualized insights of qualitative data and the generalizable, externally valid insights of quantitative data. The strengths of one type of data often mitigate the weaknesses of the other.

For example, solely quantitative studies often struggle to incorporate the lived experiences of your participants, so adding qualitative data deepens and enriches your quantitative results.

Solely qualitative studies are often not very generalizable, only reflecting the experiences of your participants, so adding quantitative data can validate your qualitative findings.



Method flexibility; Mixed methods are less tied to disciplines and established research paradigms. They offer more flexibility in designing your research, allowing you to combine aspects of different types of studies to distill the most informative results.

Mixed methods research can also combine theory generation and hypothesis testing within a single study, which is unusual for standalone qualitative or quantitative studies.

Disadvantages of mixed methods research

Workload; Mixed methods research is very labor-intensive. Collecting, analyzing, and synthesizing two types of data into one research product takes a lot of time and effort, and often involves interdisciplinary teams of researchers rather than individuals. For this reason, mixed methods research has the potential to cost much more than standalone studies.

Differing or conflicting results

If your analysis yields conflicting results, it can be very challenging to know how to interpret them in a mixed methods study. If the quantitative and qualitative results do not agree or you are concerned you may have confounding variables, it can be unclear how to proceed.

Due to the fact that quantitative and qualitative data take two vastly different forms, it can also be difficult to find ways to systematically compare the results.

C).PRIMARY AND SECONDARY SOURCES OF

INFORMATION/DATA IN RESEARCH

The various sources of information may be categorized into primary, secondary or tertiary.

A). Primary sources

The sources that contain original information and observations are known as primary sources of information. Such information can be collected directly from the persons having such information



or can be found in research papers published in legal periodicals/ journals, reports, theses and conference papers.

A primary source is an account of an event by a participant or eyewitness at the time. While often textual, primary sources may take other forms in various areas of research. Works of art, scientific or sociological data, archeological artifacts, and official government proceedings also constitute primary sources.

Legal periodicals and journals are indispensable sources of information for a legal researcher. They contain wealth of the first hand and in-depth information on a particular point. Reports, published by Governmental or non-governmental agencies, also contain rich information on the subject of inquiry.

Doctoral dissertations (theses leading to Ph D Degree), which offer very systematic and in-depth analysis of the subject-matter/aspect delved therein and the conclusions/opinions/suggestions based on the analysis, constitute another primary source of information. Similar is the case of conference papers.

Primary sources in legal research, therefore, are the

- **Constitution⁵⁹**- The constitution is a supreme law of the land from which other laws derive their validity. It is a Fundamental body of principles. **Article 260** provides for the Supremacy of the Constitution and hence all other laws are subject to it.
- National Gazette,
- which publish Acts/Proclamations passed by Parliament (and by State Legislature) This is a document of written law passed by a legislative body such as the Parliament. It is a positive statement of legal weight created by the legislature. Statutes such as; **The Penal Code Act⁶¹**, **The Contracts Act⁶²**
- Rules,

⁵⁹ Constitution of the Republic of Uganda 1995 (as amended).

⁶⁰ Article 2(2) If any other law is inconsistent with any of the provisions of this Constitution shall prevail, and that other law or custom, to that extent of the inconsistency, to be void.

⁶¹ Penal Code Act (Cap 120)

⁶² Contracts Act (2010)



- Regulations, Published under the authority of a statute that further and operates to impact the statutory intent. **E.g. Ministry Of Health Regulations on the COVID 19 pandemic⁶³**
- Statutory Orders, and Directives of Administrative Agencies, and case reports that publish judicial pronouncements of different higher courts.
- **Case Law**- Case law is the collection of past judicial decisions written by courts and similar tribunals in the course of deciding cases. **Section 14(3)** of the **Judicature Act⁶⁴** provides for the application of common law and the doctrines of equity in Uganda. Therefore, it is important for a legal researcher to consider decided cases in their research process.
- **Court opinions**- Decisions of the court with reasoning supporting the conclusion. In a parliamentary debate of **Local Government Act 1986 (Amendment) Bill**, **Lord Denning** said “...We must not allow this cult of homosexuality, making it equal with heterosexuality, to develop in our land. We must preserve our moral and spiritual values....”

All these sources contain rich original information/observations about the identified research problem. They are indeed indispensable for any legal researcher.

B).Secondary sources

Secondary sources of information furnish the information derived from primary sources. These sources organize the information in a systematic manner and in a planned way.

A secondary source interprets, discusses or analyzes. Secondary sources are usually texts. An author of a secondary source may be distant in time or geography from the primary source analyzed. Or a secondary source may be based on other secondary sources.

These secondary sources include;

Abstracts are brief statements of the contents of research articles published in periodicals and/or anthologies, without appraisal. Abstracts provide a simplified key to find relevant studies from the vast literature on the subject.

⁶³ Public Health Act, Public Health (Control of COVID - 19) (No. 2) Rules, 2020

⁶⁴Judicature Act (Chapter 13))



Bibliographies list books and related materials on a particular subject. They contain the author's name, title, place of publication, publisher and the year of publication. An annotated bibliography provides a brief analysis of the contents.

Dictionary contains an alphabetical listing of words with their meaning, spelling, pronunciation, derivation and grammatical usage. However, with the growth of knowledge, it has not been possible for general language dictionaries to keep up with technical terms developed in the various fields. So the need for subject specific dictionaries arose. A legal researcher, therefore, can find a couple of legal dictionaries⁶⁵ of worth consulting. The most frequently referred to, and widely used, is Black's Law Dictionary.⁶⁶

Encyclopedia is a book of information in the form of condensed articles on every subject. It furnishes greater details (of the subjects dealt thereunder) than a dictionary. It provides meaning and historical background of concepts, important theories, names and references of major works. Encyclopedia is thus the treasure house of knowledge on various subjects, including law. There are a number of encyclopedias that may be, depending upon his subject of inquiry, of great use to a legal researcher.⁶⁷

Indexes are alphabetical listing of subjects and/or authors of the literature included therein. According to William A Katz, 'Index' is a detailed list of names, terms, subjects, places or other significant items in a complete work with exact page or other reference to material included in the work.⁶⁸ Harold Borko and Charles L Bernier have explained it more lucidly and

⁶⁵ For example see, Bryan A Garner, A Dictionary of Modern Legal Usage (Oxford, New York, 2nd edn, 1995), Steven H Gifis, Barron's Dictionary of Legal Terms (Barroni Educational Service, Inc, New York, 3rd edn, 1998), James R Fox, Dictionary of International and Comparative Law (Oceana Publication, Inc, 3rd edn, 2003), and L B Curzon, Dictionary of Law (Pearson/Longman, UK, 6th edn, 2002).

⁶⁶ Henry Campbell Black, *Black's Law Dictionary* (St Paul, Minn. West Publishing Co., USA, 6th edn, 1990) and Bryan A Garner, *Black's Law Dictionary* (St Paul, Minn. West Publishing Co., USA, 7th edn, 1990).

⁶⁷ Widely used legal encyclopedia are Halsbury's Statutes of England and Wales (a multi-volume publication of Butterworths, London) and Halsbury's Laws of England (published by Butterworths, London, in a series of volumes), which give detailed and up-to-date account of statutes and of law on a particular subject. A legal researcher's task of locating these statutes and cases is further made easy by Consolidated Table of Statutory Instruments 2006, Consolidated Table of Cases 2005, and Halsbury's Statutes Citor 2005. Other useful

encyclopedias are: 'An Encyclopedia of Definitions and Interpretations of Legally Significant Words and Phrases' (published by St Paul, Minn. West Publishing Co, USA), Words and Phrases (a multi-volume series, which gives an judicial constructions, definitions of words and phrases by the State and Federal Courts from 1658 to date, is published by St Paul, Minn. West Publishing Co., USA),

⁶⁸ William A Katz, *Introduction to Reference Work*, vol 1 (McGraw-Hill, New York, 1969) at 92.



comprehensively. According to them, the artificiality created by the indexing system is a mental process for quick retrieval of information. In their words, 'indexing is the process of analyzing the informational content of records of knowledge and expressing the informational content in language of the indexing system.'⁶⁹ Index, thus, helps to quickly recall or retrieve most relevant information and thereby to establish a contact between producer of idea or information (i.e. author) and consumer of information (i.e. reader) through organizer of information (i.e. indexer/librarian). It not only helps the reader to locate the required information immediately but also facilitates the identification or selection of the desired documents and provides comprehensive overview of the subject.⁷⁰

A review is an integrated and organized discussion of the literature pertaining to a well-defined subject. It usually covers a limited period of time.

A thesaurus is a book of words grouped by ideas. Its purpose is to help identify synonymous and find the exact word. Roget's 'Thesaurus'⁷¹ accomplishes this task for the English language. With an ever-increasing list of technical words. Thesauri are also available for many disciplines, including law. These are compilations of the vocabulary used to identify concepts in the literature within a given area.

Advantages and disadvantages of primary and secondary sources

In a time when data is becoming easily accessible to researchers all over the world, the practicality of utilizing secondary data for research is becoming more prevalent, same as its questionable authenticity when compared with primary data.

These 2 types of data, when considered for research is a double-edged sword because it can equally make a research project as well as it can mar it.

⁶⁹ William A Katz, Introduction to Reference Work, vol 1 (McGraw-Hill, New York, 1969) at 92.

⁷⁰ In the field of law, there are a good number of usable indexes. For details see, Unit 3: Doctrinal and Non- Doctrinal Legal Research, *infra*.

⁷¹ Christopher Orlando Sylvester Mawson, Roget's International Thesaurus (Oxford, New Delhi, 1978). It is also available in a pocket size edition, see Christopher Orlando Sylvester Mawson, Roget's Pocket Thesaurus (Pocket Books, New York, 1946).



In a nutshell, primary data and secondary data both have their advantages and disadvantages. Therefore, when carrying out research, it is left for the researcher to weigh these factors and choose the better one.

It is therefore important for one to study the similarities and differences between these data types so as to make proper decisions when choosing a better data type for research work.

What is Primary Data?

Primary data is the kind of data that is collected directly from the data source without going through any existing sources. It is mostly collected specially for a research project and may be shared publicly to be used for other research.

Primary data is often reliable, authentic, and objective in as much as it was collected with the purpose of addressing a particular research problem. It is noteworthy that primary data is not commonly collected because of the high cost of implementation.

A common example of primary data is the data collected by organizations during market research, product research, and competitive analysis. This data is collected directly from its original source which in most cases are the existing and potential customers.

Most of the people who collect primary data are government authorized agencies, investigators, research-based private institutions, etc.

Primary data is specific to the needs of the researcher at the moment of data collection. The researcher is able to control the kind of data that is being collected.

Advantages;

1. It is accurate compared to secondary data. The data is not subjected to personal bias and as such the authenticity can be trusted.
2. The researcher exhibit ownership of the data collected through primary research. He or she may choose to make it available publicly, patent it, or even sell it.



3. Primary data is usually up to date because it collects data in real-time and does not collect data from old sources.
4. The researcher has full control over the data collected through primary research. He can decide which design, method, and data analysis techniques to be used.

Disadvantages;

1. Primary data is very expensive compared to secondary data. Therefore, it might be difficult to collect primary data.
2. It is time-consuming.
3. It may not be feasible to collect primary data in some cases due to its complexity and required commitment.

What is Secondary Data?

Secondary data is the data that has been collected in the past by someone else but made available for others to use. They are usually once primary data but become secondary when used by a third party.

Secondary data are usually easily accessible to researchers and individuals because they are mostly shared publicly. This, however, means that the data are usually general and not tailored specifically to meet the researcher's needs as primary data does.

For example, when conducting a research thesis, researchers need to consult past works done in this field and add findings to the literature review. Some other things like definitions and theorems are secondary data that are added to the thesis to be

properly referenced and cited accordingly.

Some common sources of secondary data include trade publications, government statistics, journals, etc. In most cases, these sources cannot be trusted as authentic.

Advantages;



Secondary data is easily accessible compared to primary data. Secondary data is available on different platforms that can be accessed by the researcher.

Secondary data is very affordable. It requires little to no cost to acquire them because they are sometimes given out for free.

The time spent on collecting secondary data is usually very little compared to that of primary data.

Secondary data makes it possible to carry out longitudinal studies without having to wait for a long time to draw conclusions.

It helps to generate new insights into existing primary data.

Disadvantages;

Secondary data may not be authentic and reliable. A researcher may need to further verify the data collected from the available sources.

Researchers may have to deal with irrelevant data before finally finding the required data. Some of the data is exaggerated due to the personal bias of the data source.

Secondary data sources are sometimes outdated with no new data to replace the old ones.

Here are 15 differences between primary and

secondary data; Definition

Primary data is the type of data that is collected by researchers directly from main sources while secondary data is the data that has already been collected through primary sources and made readily available for researchers to use for their own research.

The main difference between these 2 definitions is the fact that primary data is collected from the main source of data, while secondary data is not.

The secondary data made available to researchers from existing sources are formerly primary data that was collected for research in the past. The availability of secondary data is highly dependent on the primary researcher's decision to share their data publicly or not.



Examples:

An example of primary data is the national census data collected by the government while an example of secondary data is the data collected from online sources. The secondary data collected from an online source could be the primary data collected by another researcher.

For example, the government, after successfully the national census, share the results in newspapers, online magazines, press releases, etc. Another government agency that is trying to allocate the state budget for healthcare, education, etc. may need to access the census results.

With access to this information, the number of children who needs education can be analyzed and hard to determine the amount that should be allocated to the education sector. Similarly, knowing the number of old people will help in allocating funds for them in the health sector.

Data Types

The type of data provided by primary data is real-time, while the data provided by secondary data is stale. Researchers are able to have access to the most recent data when conducting primary research, which may not be the case for secondary data.

Secondary data have to depend on primary data that has been collected in the past to perform research. In some cases, the researcher may be lucky that the data is collected close to the time that he or she is conducting research.

Therefore, reducing the amount of difference between the secondary data being used and the recent data.

Process; Researchers are usually very involved in the primary data collection process, while secondary data is quick and easy to collect. This is due to the fact that primary research is mostly longitudinal.

Therefore, researchers have to spend a long time performing research, recording information, and analyzing the data. This data can be collected and analyzed within a few hours when conducting secondary research. For example, an organization may spend a long time analyzing the market size for transport companies looking to talk into the ride-hailing sector. A potential investor will take this data and use it to inform his decision of investing in the sector or not.



Availability; Primary data is available in crude form while secondary data is available in a refined form. That is, secondary data is usually made available to the public in a simple form for a layman to understand while primary data are usually raw and will have to be simplified by the researcher.

Secondary data are this way because they have previously been broken down by researchers who collected the primary data afresh. A good example is the Thomson Reuters annual market reports that are made available to the public.

When Thomson Reuters collect this data afresh, they are usually raw and may be difficult to understand. They simplify the results of this data by visualizing it with graphs, charts, and explanations in words.

Data Collection Tools; Primary data can be collected using surveys and questionnaires while secondary data are collected using the library, bots, etc. The different ones between these data collection tools are glaring and can it be interchangeably used.

When collecting primary data, researchers lookout for a tool that can be easily used and can collect reliable data. One of the best primary data collection tools that satisfy this condition is Formplus. Formplus is a web-based primary data collection tool that helps researchers collect reliable data while simultaneously increasing the response rate from respondents.

Sources; Primary data sources include; Surveys, observations, experiments, questionnaires, focus groups, interviews, etc., while secondary data sources include; books, journals, articles, web pages, blogs, etc. These sources vary explicitly and there is no intersection between the primary and secondary data sources.

Primary data sources are sources that require a deep commitment from researchers and require interaction with the subject of study. Secondary data, on the other hand, do not require interaction with the subject of study before it can be collected.

In most cases, secondary researchers do not have any interaction with the subject of research.

Specific; Primary data is always specific to the researcher's needs, while secondary data may or may not be specific to the researcher's needs. It depends solely on the kind of data the researcher was able to lay hands on.



Secondary researchers may be lucky to have access to data tailored specifically to meet their needs, which may not be the case in some cases. For example, a market researcher researching the purchasing power of people from a particular community may not have access to the data of the subject community.

Alternatively, there may be another community with a similar standard of living to the subject community whose data is available. The researcher may use to settle for this data and use it to inform his conclusion on the subject community.

Advantage

Some common advantages of primary data are its authenticity, specific nature, and up to date information while secondary data is very cheap and not time-consuming.

Primary data is very reliable because it is usually objective and collected directly from the original source. It also gives up-to-date information about a research topic compared to secondary data.

Secondary data, on the other hand, is not expensive making it easy for people to conduct secondary research. It doesn't take so much time and most of the secondary data sources can be accessed for free.

Disadvantage

The disadvantage of primary data is the cost and time spent on data collection while secondary data may be outdated or irrelevant. Primary data incur so much cost and takes time because of the processes involved in carrying out primary research.

For example, when physically interviewing research subjects, one may need one or more professionals, including the interviewees, videographers who will make a record of the interview in some cases and the people involved in preparing for the interview. Apart from the time required, the cost of doing this may be relatively high.

Secondary data may be outdated and irrelevant. In fact, researchers have to surf through irrelevant data before finally having access to the data relevant to the research purpose.



Accuracy and Reliability; Primary data is more accurate and reliable while secondary data is relatively less reliable and accurate. This is mainly because the secondary data sources are not regulated and are subject to personal bias. A good example of this is business owners who pay bloggers to write good reviews about their product just to gain more customers. This is not the case with primary data which is collected by being a researcher himself.

One of the researcher's aims when gathering primary data for research will be gathering accurate data so as to arrive at correct conclusions. Therefore, biases will be avoided at all costs (e.g. some businesses when collecting feedback from customers).

Cost-effectiveness; Primary data is very expensive while secondary data is economical. When working on a low budget, it is better for researchers to work with secondary data, then analyze it to uncover new trends. In fact, a researcher might work with both primary data and secondary data for one research. This is usually very advisable in cases whereby the available secondary data does not fully meet the research needs.

Therefore, a little extension on the available data will be done and cost will also be saved. For example, a researcher may require a market report from 2010 to 2019 while the available reports stop at 2018.

Collection Time; The time required to collect primary data is usually long while that required to collect secondary data is usually short. The primary data collection process is sometimes longitudinal in nature.

Therefore, researchers may need to observe the research subject for some time while taking down important data. For example, when observing the behavior of a group of people or particular species, researchers have to observe them for a while.

Secondary data can, however, be collected in a matter of minutes and analyzed to reach conclusions—taking a shorter time when compared to primary data. In some rare

cases, especially when collecting little data, secondary data may take a longer time because of difficulty consulting different data sources to find the right data.

Similarities between Primary & Secondary Data



Contains Same Content: Secondary data was once primary data when it was newly collected by the first researcher. The content of the data collected does not change and therefore has the same content as primary data.

It doesn't matter if it was further visualized in the secondary form, the content does not change. A common example of these are definitions, theorems, and postulates that were made years ago but still remain the same.

Uses; Primary data and secondary data are both used in research and statistics. They can be used to carry out the same kind of research in these fields depending on data availability. This is because secondary data and primary data have the same content. The only difference is the method by which they are collected.

Since the method of collection does not directly affect the uses of data, they can be used to perform similar research. For example, whether collected directly or from an existing database, the demography of a particular target market can be used to inform similar business decisions.

Conclusion; When performing research, it is important to consider the available data options so as to ensure that the right type of data is used to arrive at a feasibility conclusion. A good understanding of the different data types, similarities, and differences are however required to do this.

Primary data and secondary data both have applications in business and research. They may, however, differ from each other in the way in which they are collected, used, and analyzed.

The most common setback with primary data is that it is very expensive, which is not the case for secondary data. Secondary data, on the other hand, has authenticity issues.

Relevance of Primary data; What does each and every research project need to get results? Data – or information – to help answer questions, understand a specific issue

or test a hypothesis.

Researchers in the health and social sciences can obtain their data by getting it directly from the subjects they're interested in. This data they collect is called primary data. Another type of data that may help researchers is the data that has already been gathered by someone else. This is called secondary data.



What are the advantages of using these two types of data? Which tends to take longer to process and which is more expensive? This column will help to explain the differences between primary and secondary data.

Primary data

An advantage of using primary data is that researchers are collecting information for the specific purposes of their study. In essence, the questions the researchers ask are tailored to elicit the data that will help them with their study. Researchers collect the data themselves, using surveys, interviews and direct observations.

In the field of workplace health research, for example, direct observations may involve a researcher watching people at work. The researcher could count and code the number of times she sees practices or behaviours relevant to her interest; e.g. instances of improper lifting posture or the number of hostile or disrespectful interactions workers engage in with clients and customers over a period of time.

To take another example, let's say a research team wants to find out about workers' experiences in return to work after a work-related injury. Part of the research may involve interviewing workers by telephone about how long they were off work and about their experiences with the return-to-work process. The workers' answers—considered primary data—will provide the researchers with specific information about the return-to-work process; e.g. they may learn about the frequency of work accommodation offers, and the reasons some workers refused such offers.

Secondary data

There are several types of secondary data. They can include information from the national population census and other government information collected by Statistics Canada. One type of secondary data that's used increasingly is administrative data. This term refers to data that is collected routinely as part of the day-to-day operations of an organization, institution or agency. There are any number of examples: motor

vehicle registrations, hospital intake and discharge records, workers' compensation claims records, and more.

Compared to primary data, secondary data tends to be readily available and inexpensive to obtain. In addition, administrative data tends to have large samples, because the data collection is



comprehensive and routine. What's more, administrative data (and many types of secondary data) are collected over a long period. That allows researchers to detect change over time.

Going back to the return-to-work study mentioned above, the researchers could also examine secondary data in addition to the information provided by their primary data (i.e. survey results). They could look at workers' compensation lost-time claims data to determine the amount of time workers were receiving wage replacement benefits. With a combination of these two data sources, the researchers may be able to determine which factors predict a shorter work absence among injured workers. This information could then help improve return to work for other injured workers.

The type of data researchers choose can depend on many things including the research question, their budget, their skills and available resources. Based on these and other factors, they may choose to use primary data, secondary data—or both.

Relevance of secondary data.

What is Secondary Data Analysis?

Secondary data analysis involves a researcher using the information that someone else has gathered for his or her own purposes. Researchers leverage secondary data analysis in an attempt to answer a new research question, or to examine an alternative perspective on the original question of a previous study.

If an entrepreneur is considering opening a new business, he or she could leverage census data that has been collected by the government.

Although the entrepreneur would not be collecting the data his or herself, census data includes information that could greatly benefit the entrepreneur, such as the average age, household income and education level in a particular geographical region.

By digging into this census data to inform the decision of whether or not the

entrepreneur should open the new business, the entrepreneur is performing secondary data analysis.

SIKIA
Low

There are certain factors that a researcher must consider before deciding to move forward with secondary data analysis;

Because the researcher did not collect the data that he or she will be working with, it's imperative for him or her to become familiar with the data set. This familiarization process entails:

Learning about how the data was collected

Learning who the population of the study

was

Learning what the objective of the original study was

Determining what the response categories were for each question displayed to survey respondents
Evaluating whether or not weights need to be applied during the analysis of the data

Deciding whether or not clusters or stratification need to be accounted for during the analysis of the data

One of the most noticeable advantages of using secondary data analysis is its cost effectiveness.

Because someone else has already collected the data, the researcher does not need to invest any money, time, or effort into the data collection stages of his or her study.

While sometimes secondary data must be purchased by a researcher looking to use it to inform a study they're working on, these costs are almost always lower than what the expenses would be if the researcher were to create the same data set from scratch.

Also, the data from a secondary data set is typically already cleaned and stored in an electronic format, so the researcher can spend his or her time rolling up their sleeves and analyzing the data instead of spending time having to prepare the data for analysis.

Another benefit of analyzing secondary data instead of collecting and analyzing primary data is the sheer volume and breadth of data that is publicly available today. For instance, leveraging the findings from studies that the government has conducted provides researchers with access to a volume of data that would have simply been impossible for the researcher to amass themselves.



Longitudinal data at this scale is extremely powerful. The government could have been collecting data on a single population for long, extended periods of time. Instead of investing that time, by using the government's publically available data to perform secondary data analysis, the researcher has avoided years of intensive labor.

The Disadvantages of Secondary Data Analysis;

The biggest disadvantage of performing secondary data analysis is that the secondary data set might not answer the researcher's specific research question to the degree that the research would have hoped.

If a researcher sets out to perform a study with a very particular question in mind, a secondary data set might not contain the precisely specific information that would allow the researcher to answer his or her question.

Similarly, when a researcher has a specific question or goal in mind, it can sometimes be difficult to identify secondary data that is valid for use, as the data might not have been collected during the timeframe the researcher was hoping for, or in correct the geographical region, etc.

Another disadvantage is that no matter what a researcher does to vet a secondary data set, they will never be able to know exactly how the data was collected, and how well that process was executed. Without being the one who is actually developing surveys and distributing them to the appropriate populations, it's impossible to know the extent to which the researchers that collected the data went to ensure validity or quality, or if they experienced issues such as low response rates or respondents misunderstanding what a question was truly asking.

Simply put, since the researcher conducting the study did not collect the data he or she will be using, he or she ultimately has no control over what their secondary data set contains.

Conclusion

Secondary data analysis is a convenient and powerful tool for researchers looking to ask broad questions at a large scale.

While it has its benefits, such as its cost effectiveness and the breadth and depth of data that it provides access to, secondary data analysis can also force researchers to alter their original question, or work with a data set that otherwise is not ideal for their goals.

INTRODUCTION OF DATA ANALYSIS

According to **Le Compte and Schensul**, Research data analysis is the process used by researchers for reducing data to story and interpreting to derive insights.

According to **Marshall and Rossman** they describe data analysis as a messy, ambiguous, but a creative and fascinating process through which a mass of collected data is being brought to order, structure and meaning.

This involves the definition of data analysis, types of data analysis the main types being qualitative Analysis its process and methods together with quantitative and its methods. Other types of data analysis especially computer data analysis advantages of data analysis and challenges related with data analysis.

Data can be analyzed qualitatively or quantitatively.

In qualitative analysis the important thing is under presentation of results in all tables, charts, graphs, that is to say they should be clearly labeled and explained so that researchers may understand the report therefore it should be presented with the research question.

TYPES OF DATA ANALYSIS

Qualitative analysis

When the data presented has words and descriptions, then it is called qualitative.

This type of data is usually collected through focus groups, This focuses on depth of personal qualitative interviews, use of open ended questions in surveys, observations, and document analysis.

This interprets data with out numerical analysis

Some qualitative research includes limited quantification especially counting number of occurrences of an event.

It is typically used for exploratory research.

There are three processes of qualitative analysis namely; data description, data interpretation and data organization.

Data organization is the critical process due to often volumes of data collected in qualitative data. **Data description** involves the setting in which data where collected and participants in the study. **Data interpretation** involves interpretation of data.

Data analysis in qualitative research is manual in that researchers usually read the available data. For instance in carrying out research on data collected from Africa one may find out that most issues affecting Africa is hunger and poverty.

Data preparation for data analysis of qualitative research.

In order for nominal data to be converted into meaningful data, it involves data preparation.

Data validation is done to determine if the the collected data sample is per the per

set standards or biased. Screening to make sure each participant is selected or chosen in compliance with the research criteria.



Data editing.

Data editing is the process where in the researchers have to confirm data collected by doing necessary checks and outlier checks to edit the raw edit and make it ready for analysis.

Data coding.

This the critical phase of data preparation which is associated with Grouping and assigning values to the survey responses.

Methods of qualitative data Analysis

1. Content analysis

This technique/ method is one of the most frequently used in analyzing data in research methodology. Can be used to analyse documented information from texts, images and sometimes from physical items.

Analysis of the content of Data. Through content Analysis table one can easily identify which codes were used to analyse aggregate data and this is done by viewing the code book to enable get exact passage.

2. Narrative analysis

This method is used to analyze content gathered from various sources such as personal interviews, field observation and surveys.

3. Discourse Analysis

This one is used to analyze the interactions with people. Therefore it considers within which the communication between the researcher and the respondent takes place.

It also focuses on the life style and day today environment to derive at the conclusion.

4. Grounded theory

This helps to explain why particular phenomenon happened, it is applied to study data about the host of similar cases occurring in different settings. It enables alteration of explanation to arrive at the conclusion.



Document analysis as form of qualitative analysis.

Document analysis is the form of qualitative Research in which documents are interpreted by the researcher to give voice and meaning around an assessment topic.

Analyzing documents incorporates coding the content into themes similar to the focus group or interview scripts are analyzed(Bowen)

Advantages of document analysis

1. Contain spontaneous data
2. Requires data selection instead of data collection.
3. Accessibility to information that would be difficult to get in any way ie readily available
4. Confessional documents may give an insight of how people see things or how they want to present things.
5. Exactness
6. Relatively low cost, particularly when documents are easily accessible and already based on work place, or on interest.

Disadvantages of document analysis.

1. Are usually not designed with research in mind
2. Information recorded may be idiosyncratic, bias or incomplete can be subjective
3. Ethical principles may be contravened.

QUANTITATIVE DATA ANALYSIS

It requires statistical testing or any data expressed in numbers of Numerical figures. This type of data can be distinguished into categories, grouped, measured, calculated or ranked.

Statistical Analysis

This is more specialized with field but students of research needs at least an aspect of data analysis which is rudimentary. Example is questions such as age, rank, cost, length, weight,

There are four major statistical testing that could be used to analyse data and these include;



1. **Test of significance.** This is a formal procedure for comparing observed data with a claim(hypothesis), the truth of which is being assessed. For instance; A t-test which compares means of 2 samples.

2. Test of central tendency.

Test of central tendency is a summary measure that attempts to describe a whole set of data with single value that represents the middle or centre of its distribution. For instance; mode, median. This enables researchers to summarize data.

3. Test of variation.

Test of variation is a specific set of variable values for a test case. Calculated by taking average squared deviations from the mean.

4. Parametric and non parametric tests;

parametric tests are those that make assumptions about parameters of the population distribution from which the sample is drawn where as non parametric tests are not based on assumptions, that is data can be collected from the sample that does not follow a specific distribution.

Advantages of quantitative analysis

1. They could also use charts, graphs, diagrams, models and other figures to drive home the points to provide understanding of the solution to the problem.
2. For orderliness and systematic solution of the research problem, the hypothesis could be tackled once after the other and the appropriate test used.
3. Categorical data this data is presented in groups, however an item included in categorical data cannot belong to more than one group. Example person responding to the survey

Methods used for data analysis in quantitative research

Descriptive statistics

This is the quantitative method of data analysis used to describe the basic features of versatile types of data in research.

Inferential statistics which helps in comparing the data. It allows researchers to make assumptions.

Below are **inferential**

methods Cross tabulation

It is also known as contingency tables. This method is used to analyze the relationship between multiple variables. For example provided data has age and gender categories presented in rows and columns.

Regression Analysis

Enables easy understanding of the strong relationship between two variables, researchers do not look beyond the primary and commonly used regression. It is also a type of predictive analysis and in this involve dependent variables, and multiple independent variables.

COMPUTER DATA ANALYSIS

The electronic digital computer is one of the most versatile developments of the technological age.

Unit of Analysis refer to the entity which include individuals, groups, organizations, behaviour, objects, cities and nations.

In scientific research, the research questions determines the unit of analysis which its identification may sometimes be tricky. For instance study of why certain neighbourhood has higher crime rate than the surroundings.

Another example is where some one considers a study in which a researcher wants to examine differences between death penalty and laws across the states which will in turn involve unit of analysis called death penalty laws.

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If the unit of analysis is a policy or the law, then some one should be gathering legislative and legal documents rather than observing legislator's day today lives.

Coding

It involves a process for interpretation of large segments of texts and portions of data. Include Saldama code book resource(structural coding).

To explore the relationship between the pre-employment alignment or career expectations and post employment experience, job satisfaction.

Computer Assisted Qualitative Data Analysis Software(CAQDAS) has become popular for processing large amounts of qualitative Analysis of Data in learning the principles of coding.

Interator reliability.

Enables one to access and establish trust and confidence in finding research(Thomas and Magilry, 2011

Through analyzing ample of the texts using interrator reliability in keeping with the recommendations in the literature due to substantial amount of data(Barbour, 2001, Campbell et al, 2013 Hallgren, 2012.

Influenced by the method of Hruschika et at 2004 he had conducted 3 rounds of reliability checks.

Advantages of data analysis

1. Lends credibility to the researched data
2. It backs the data up with trustworthy references and gives a theoretical base to stand on.
3. Data analysis is also an easy way to evaluate the students regarding their understanding of the research material.

4. Gives the readers an insight into what the researchers have derived from the entire data.
5. Helps to understand the personal interpretation.
6. Data analysis helps in reducing large chunks of data into smaller fragments.



CHALLENGES OF QUALITATIVE DATA ANALYSIS

1) Limited sample size.

Contrary to the quantitative data where you often have a great amount of data available, sample size is one the challenges of qualitative data analysis.

It is very costly to perform extensive qualitative research with hundreds of participants and it is really needed to question so many people to get valuable insights.

Two tips about your sample size

- ✓ **Rule of the thumb**, you need more participants if new participants keep on providing, you relevant, new insights.
- ✓ **Be flexible**, don't rigidly set the number of the participants at the start.

2) Sampling bias

sampling bias is a bias in which a sample is collected in such way that some members of the intended population are less likely to be included than others.

In other words your qualitative never include a representative overview of all different people that come to you. It is important to keep that in mind when interpreting test results.

3) Self selection bias

Do you like to participate in surveys? A few people might say “yes” and others think “ Arghh”, this is the exact problem since it is a free choice to participate in a research study or not.

On the other hand quantitative research is gathered from the most people. Sampling and self selection biases are closely related and limit the usefulness of the qualitative data.

4) Hawthorne effect

Participants in behavioral studies change their behavior or performance in response to being observed. For example your opinion about the particular website might be different when you know that they are being observed if compared to when you(don't know) being observed.

5) **Observer expecting effect**

Researchers beliefs or expectations cause them to unconsciously influence the participants of an experiment. This is called observer expecting effect.



For example let's say you're running a survey and function as an observer in the research room. You are walking around and observe the participants. Do you think you won't influence the results.

GENERAL CHALLENGES OF DATA ANALYSIS.

a) The amount of data being collected.

Researchers are often overwhelmed with the amounts of the data collected. There is a need for researchers to organize information manually which is also time consuming.

b) Collecting meaningful and real time data.

With so much data available, it is difficult to dig down and access the insights that are needed most. When researchers are overwhelmed, they may not fully analyze data or only focus on the measures that are easiest to collect instead of those that truly add value.

c) Visual representation of data.

To be understood and have impact, data often needs to be visually represented in graphs or charts. While those tools are incredibly useful, it is difficult to build them manually, taking time to pull information from multiple areas and put it into a reporting tool is frustrating and time consuming.

d) Data from multiple sources.

Trying to analyze data across multiple, disjointed sources is another challenge. Different pieces of data are often housed in different systems. Researchers may not realize this, leading to incomplete or inaccurate analysis.

e) Inaccessible data.

Moving data into a centralized system has little impact if it is not easily accessible to people that do research; therefore they need access to all pieces of data for insights on what is happening at any given time. But since data is inaccessible this may be a challenge in data analysis.

f) Poor quality data.

Nothing is more harmful to data analysis than inaccurate data. Without good input, output will be unreliable. A key cause of inaccurate data is manual errors made during data entry. When information in one system does not reflect the changes made in another system, leaving it outdated.



g) Pressure from the top.

The executives demand more results from the researchers, they expect higher returns and a larger number of reports in all kinds of data.

h) lack of support.

Researchers will be powerless in many pursuits if the executives don't give

them the ability to act. Other researchers also play a big role that is to say, if they don't analyze their data to the researcher, then it will be hard to create any actionable information.

i) Confusion or anxiety

Researchers may feel confused or anxious about switching from one data analysis method to another especially when they are comfortable and familiar with the way things are being done.

j) Shortage of skills.

Some researchers struggle with the analysis due to lack of talent. Researchers may not have the knowledge or capability to run in-depth data analysis.

ETHICS IN RESEARCH METHODS.

This is the most common way of defining "ethics": norms for conduct that distinguish between acceptable and unacceptable behavior.

In as much as most people acquire their sense of right and wrong during childhood, the moral development occurs throughout life and human beings pass through different stages of growth as they mature.

Ethical norms are so ubiquitous in that one might be tempted to regard them as simple common sense.

One plausible explanation of the above is that all people recognize some common ethical norms but they tend to apply, interpret and balance them in different ways in

light of their own values and life experiences.

Example is where two people could agree that murder is wrong but disagree about the morality of and this is because they have different understandings of what it means to be a human being.



Most societies also have legal rules that govern conduct and behavior, but ethical norms tend to be broader and more informal than laws. Although most societies use laws to enforce widely accepted moral standards, ethical and legal rules use similar concepts not the same but they are not the same. An action may be legal but unethical or illegal but ethical.

We can also use ethical concepts and principles to criticize, evaluate, propose, or interpret laws. Indeed, in the last century, many social reformers have urged citizens to disobey laws they regarded as immoral or unjust laws.

Peaceful civil disobedience is an ethical way of protesting laws or expressing political viewpoints.

Another way of defining 'ethics' is that it focuses on the disciplines that study standards of conduct, such as philosophy, theology, law, psychology, or sociology.

For example, a "medical ethicist" is someone who studies ethical standards in medicine.

One may also define ethics as a method, procedure, or perspective for deciding how to act and for analyzing complex problems and issues. For instance, in considering a complex issue like global warming, one may take an economic, ecological, political, or ethical perspective on the problem.

While an economist might examine the cost and benefits of various policies related to global warming, an environmental ethicist could examine the ethical values and principles at stake.

Many different disciplines, institutions, and professions have standards for behavior that suit their particular aims and goals. These standards also help members of the discipline to coordinate their actions or activities.

RELEVANCE OF ETHICS IN RESEARCH.

Easy report by David B. Resnik about “what is ethics in Research and is it important? December ,23rd 2020

There are several reasons why it is important to adhere to ethical norms in research.

Norms in research ethics promote the aims of data validity research, such as providing original information, knowledge, truth, and avoidance of error. For example, prohibitions against fabricating, falsifying, or misrepresenting research data promote the truth and minimize error. (avoiding plagiarism)

Many of the norms of research promote a variety of other important moral and social values, such as social responsibility, human rights, animal welfare, compliance with the law, and public health and safety. Ethical lapses in research can significantly harm human and animal subjects, students, and the public. For example: a researcher who fabricates data in a clinical trial may harm or even kill patients, and a researcher who fails to abide by regulations and guidelines relating to radiation or biological safety may jeopardize his health and safety or the health and safety of staff and students.

Many of the ethical norms help to ensure that researchers can be held accountable to the public. For instance, federal policies on research misconduct, conflicts of interest, human subject protections and the like are necessary in order to make sure that researchers who are funded by public money can be held accountable to the public.

Ethical norms in research also help to build public support for research. People are more likely to fund a research project if they can trust the quality and integrity of research.

Since research often involves a great deal of cooperation and coordination among many different people in different disciplines and institutions, , such as trust, accountability, mutual respect, and fairness. For example, Ethical standards promote the values that are essential to collaborative work, such as patenting policies, data sharing policies, guidelines for authorship, copyright and confidentiality rules in peer

review. patenting policies are designed to protect intellectual property interests while encouraging collaboration. Most researchers want to receive credit for their contributions and do not want to have their ideas stolen or disclosed prematurely.



ETHICAL PRINCIPLES

The following are some of ethical principles that various codes address:

1. **Honesty**

Strive for honesty in all scientific communications.

Honestly report data, results, methods and procedures, and publication status. Do not fabricate, falsify, or misrepresent data. Do not deceive colleagues, research sponsors, or the public.

2. **Objectivity.**

Strive to avoid bias in experimental design, data analysis, data interpretation, peer review, personnel decisions, grant writing, expert testimony, and other aspects of research where objectivity is expected or required. Avoid or minimize bias or self-deception. Disclose personal or financial interests that may affect research.

3. **Integrity**

Keep your promises and agreements; act with sincerity; strive for consistency of thought and action.

4. **Carefulness.**

Avoid careless errors and negligence; carefully and critically examine your own work and the work of your peers. Keep good records of research activities, such as data collection, research design, and correspondence with agencies or journals.

5. **Openness**

Share data, results, ideas, tools, resources. Be open to criticism and new idea to Share data, results, ideas, tools, resources. Be open to criticism and new ideas.

6. **Respect for Intellectual Property**

Honour patents, copyrights, and other forms of intellectual property. Do not use unpublished data, methods, or results without permission. Give proper

acknowledgement or credit for all contributions to research. Never plagiarize. Plagiarism of others' text, material, ideas and research results is unacceptable and constitutes a serious breach of ethical standards. A plagiarist



undermines not only his or her own reputation as a researcher, but also the credibility of the research.

7. Confidentiality

Protect confidential communications, such as papers or grants submitted for publication, personnel records, trade or military secrets, and patient records.

Research subjects are entitled to a guarantee that all information they provide about their private lives will be treated confidentially.

Researchers must prevent the use and dissemination of information that could harm individual research subjects. Research material must usually be anonymous, and strict requirements must apply for how lists of names or other information that would make it possible to identify individuals are stored and destroyed.

8. Responsible Publication

Publish in order to advance research and scholarship, not to advance just your own career

Publish in order to advance research and scholarship, not to advance just your own career. Avoid wasteful and duplicate publication.

1. Responsible Mentoring

Help to educate, mentor, and advise students. Promote their welfare and allow them to make their own decisions.

2. Social Responsibility

Strive to promote social good and prevent or mitigate social harms through research, public education, and advocacy.

3. Non-Discrimination

Avoid discrimination against colleagues or students on the basis of sex, race, ethnicity, or other factors not related to scientific competence and integrity.

4. Competence

Maintain and improve your own professional competence and expertise through lifelong education and learning; take steps to promote competence in law as a whole.



14. Legality

Know and obey relevant laws and institutional and governmental policies.

15. Human Subjects Protection

When conducting research on human subjects, minimize harms and risks and maximize benefits; respect human dignity, privacy, and autonomy; take special precautions with vulnerable populations; and strive to distribute the benefits and burdens of research fairly.

Respect for privacy aims at protecting individuals against unwanted interference and exposure. It applies not only to emotional issues, but also to questions that involve sickness and health, political and religious opinions, and sexual orientation.

Researchers should be especially compassionate when they ask questions that involve intimate issues and they should avoid placing informants under pressure.

What is perceived as sensitive information can vary from one individual or group to the next.

16. Follow Informed-Consent Rules

When done properly, the consent process ensures that individuals are voluntarily participating in the research with full knowledge of relevant risks and benefits. In many instances you will be expected to have subjects indicate an awareness of specific risks involved in your study by completing an "Informed Consent."

17. Respect for the values and motives of others

Researchers must show respect for the values and views of research subjects, even if they differ from those generally accepted by society at large.

Researchers should not ascribe irrational or unworthy motives to anyone without providing convincing arguments for doing so.

Research is often concerned with the behaviour and values of minorities, e.g. religious

groups, ethnic minorities, youth groups or political subcultures.

Researchers are under an obligation to take subjects' self-image seriously, and to avoid descriptions that diminish their legitimate rights



UNETHICAL RESEARCH ACTIVITIES

1. Publishing the same paper in two different journals without telling the editors
Submitting the same paper to different journals without telling the editors
2. Not informing a collaborator of your intent to file a patent in order to make sure that you are the sole inventor
3. Including a colleague as an author on a paper in return for a favour even though the colleague did not make a serious contribution to the paper
4. Discussing with your colleagues confidential data from a paper that you are reviewing for a journal
5. Using data, ideas, or methods you learn about while reviewing a grant or a papers without permission
6. Using an inappropriate statistical technique in order to enhance the significance of your research
7. Bypassing the peer review process and announcing your results through a press conference without giving peers adequate information to review your work
8. Conducting a review of the literature that fails to acknowledge the contributions of other people in the field or relevant prior work.
9. Stretching the truth on a grant application in order to convince reviewers that your project will make a significant contribution to the field
10. Stretching the truth on a job application or curriculum vitae
11. Giving the same research project to two graduate students in order to see who can do it the fastest
12. Overworking, neglecting, or exploiting graduate or post-doctoral students
13. Failing to keep good research records
14. Failing to maintain research data for a reasonable period of time
15. Making derogatory comments and personal attacks in your review of author's submission
16. Promising a student a better grade for sexual favours

- 17. Exposing students and staff to biological risks in violation of your institution's
- 18. Sabotaging someone's work.
- 19. Making unauthorized copies of data, papers, or computer programs



Challenges of observing research ethics

✓ **Anonymity**

This implies that you do not know who the participants are. One can only guarantee anonymity by not collecting any personally identifying information for instance names, phone numbers, email addresses. Therefore this kind of information cannot be collected.

- ✓ **Confidentiality** which implies that secrecy has to be observed in while doing research.
- ✓ **Complexity**, in that while carrying out research ethical principles like Informed consent should be observed while doing research.
- ✓ **Time consuming** in that most of the time is wasted in observing ethics while carrying out research.
- ✓ Lack of enforcement. Person willing to engage in ethical behaviour can influence recorded acts. Therefore complying with the ethics needs to be looked at in the traditional theory.
- ✓ Organizational culture. This can be identified as the beliefs and behaviors that contribute to social and psychological atmosphere. This culture represents the system of shared assumption, values and belief which is related to governing how people behave.

Challenges of not observing research ethics

- ✓ Impact on the employment performance. This happens in the following ways employment relations are affected and may result into termination of the employments contract and losing the reputation.
- ✓ Losing the credibility of your research. This is so because it will be difficult for other people to trust your data if your methods are morally questionable.
- ✓ Decline of the general moral and productivity. Especially on the companies that employ researchers. For example Arthur Andersen known as Big Five one of the

accounting firm was required to surrender its licence to practice and went bankrupt over its unethical behaviour related to one of the clients.

- ✓ Financial loss resulting from behaviour. As a result of failing to observe ethics, it can result into significant fines.
- ✓ Imprisonment for failing to observe ethical principles. This may happen especially failing to observe Respect for Intellectual Property, Confidentiality, discrimination of other people and failing to observe human Subjects Protection principle.



RESEARCH PROPOSAL

A research proposal is a concise and coherent summary of your proposed research. It sets out the central issues or questions that you intend to address. It outlines the general area of study within which your research falls, referring to the current state of knowledge and any recent debates on the topic. It also demonstrates the originality of your proposed research.

A research proposal is a written document that includes the introduction part which introduces your research idea, establish its importance and explain its significance. The literature review is an exploration of what other researchers have done in the area of study, while the research methodology explain in details how the research will be conducted. It provides a written description of the specific actions, plan, or strategy you will take to answer your research questions.

In a research proposal, the goal is to present the author's plan for the research they intend to conduct, the author demonstrates how and why their research is relevant to their field. A research proposal also demonstrates that the author is capable of conducting this research and contributing to the current state of their field in a meaningful way. To do this, your research proposal needs to discuss your academic background and credentials as well as demonstrate that your proposed ideas have academic merit.

The format for the writing a research proposal may vary from one department to another and as a result research students need to check with the department.

Contents of a Research Proposal

The contents or formats of a research proposal vary depending on the requirements of evaluation committee and are generally provided by the evaluation committee or the institution. In other words, there is no set template for a research proposal. Thus, the components of a research proposal include, but are not limited to those discussed

below.

3. **The title**

Try to come up with a title that is unique and at the same time easy to remember. It should also make a lasting impression to the reader and make them want to come back and read your proposal. The title must also capture the main concepts of the study. As the research process is lengthy, it is



important that you choose a topic that you are so curious about that you remain motivated for the duration of the research process. Select a topic that you will be able to complete within the time frame that you have for your research.

4. The background

The background to the topic of your intended research must be clear and precise. It must not only include an in-depth explanation of the key points of your subject but also all the developments in the field as well as their timelines. The researcher must also explain the compelling interest in the research issue as well as the personal interest (if any) in the topic. This section must also indicate the specific area within which the topic falls in your particular field of study or subject. Also, how will the proposed study contribute to a particular field? In other words, the impact and the significance in a subject area must be clearly outlined. The target audience must also be clearly described.

5. Abstract

The proposal should include a concise statement of your intended research of no more than 300 words. This may be a couple of sentences setting out the problem that you want to examine or the central question that you wish to address.

6. Introduction to the research

This section of the proposal must provide a broad overview of the topic. The jargon and key terms used in the particular topic must also be thoroughly explained in order to avoid confusion. The interest of the researcher in the particular topic must also be clearly outlined while at the same time mentioning, albeit briefly at this point, a critical review of the main literature that covers the topic. The researcher must also provide the aim of the research by clearly and concisely stating the problem, as well as the research questions to be dealt with. This section must also indicate what the research study will not be covering.

7. The research questions

The proposal should set out the central aims and questions that will guide your research. Before writing your proposal, you should take time to reflect on the key questions that you are seeking to answer. Many research proposals are too broad, so reflecting on your key research questions is a



good way to make sure that your project is sufficiently narrow and feasible. One must ensure that you use simple language that is easy to understand, while being cognizant of the level of your intended audience.

8. Objectives of the research

It is important that the objectives are in alignment with the research questions. The objectives must indicate what the aim of the research study is. In fact, objectives give you a clear indication of the steps that you will take to achieve the aim of the research. The objectives must be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant and time-bound.

9. Research methodology / research methods

The proposal should outline your research methods, explaining how you are going to conduct your research. Your methods may include visiting particular libraries or archives, field work or interviews.

Most research is library-based. If your proposed research is library-based, you should explain where your key resources (e.g. law reports, journal articles) are located. If you plan to conduct field work or collect empirical data, you should provide details about this e.g. if you plan interviews, who will you interview? How many interviews will you conduct? Will there be problems of access? This section should also explain how you are going to analyse your research findings

This section outlines the approach which the researcher will follow in order to address the research problem and to answer all the research questions from the researcher. The research design must be clearly defined, e.g., is the research Descriptive, Correlational, Causal-Comparative/Quasi- Experimental, Experimental, Diagnostic or Explanatory.

10. Literature review

Collect and present relevant literature on your topic of choice. It is important to include all the main authors or experts in a particular field. Depending on your field of

study or topic, ensure that you include recent literature as well as literature that presents counterarguments to the topic. The justification for the study needs to be based on existing literature. [Click here for more information on how to write a literature review.](#)



11. Limitations and delimitations of the study

The researcher must indicate the limitations of the study which are what the researcher cannot do or factors that are beyond the researcher's control, as well as delimitations that the researcher chooses not to address for the purposes of the study. Delimitations are boundaries that the researcher has set for the study. The reasons both for limitations and delimitations must be discussed in this section.

12. Significance of the research

The researcher must provide justification for the need to conduct the study. What is the gap that the study will fill, and what is its contribution to the existing body of knowledge? The originality and importance of the research which will be level appropriate, must be clearly described, for instance, the required level of originality for a fourth year research project is different to that of a doctoral candidate.

The impact of the study for the subject field must be indicated. In other words, how will the research improve the field, who will it impact, how will it make changes in your industry or field etc.? Lastly, the proposed research must be relatable, interesting and engaging.

13. Work plan

You should include an outline of the various stages and corresponding time lines for developing and implementing the research, including writing up your thesis.

14. Bibliography

The proposal should include a short bibliography identifying the most relevant works for your topic. All the sources that you have used for your proposal must be listed in alphabetical order using a referencing style that your lecturer has prescribed for your subject field.

ABSTRACT

An abstract in a research proposal summarizes the main aspect of the assignment in a given sequence in 300 words or less. It highlights the purpose of the study, the research problem, design of the study, findings, summary of your interpretations and conclusions.



For what it's worth, the abstract of your research proposal should give a clear and concise elaboration of the major aspects of an issue you've investigated.

In this guide, you'll learn how to write an abstract for any research proposal. We'll look at why an abstract is important, the types of abstracts, writing style, and what to avoid when it comes to writing an abstract for your research proposal.

Types of Abstracts for a Research Proposal

There are four types of abstracts that you can write for a research proposal:

6. Critical abstract
7. Descriptive abstract
8. Informative abstract
9. Highlight abstract

1. Critical abstract

A critical abstract in a research proposal describes the primary findings and gives a solid judgment on the validity, completeness, and reliability of the study. It's your responsibility as a researcher to evaluate your work and then compare it with already existing work on the same subject.

Because a critical abstract includes an additional commentary, it tends to be longer. Often, the length falls between 400 and 500 words. However, do keep in mind that this type of an abstract is very rare, which means your instructor may never ask you to write a critical abstract for your research proposal.

2. Highlight Abstract

A highlight abstract is a piece of writing that can't stand independent of its associated document. It uses incomplete and leading remarks, with the primary goal of grabbing the attention of the reader to the study.

Professors have made it clear that a highlight abstract is not by itself a true abstract to use in a research proposal. Since it cannot stand on its own separate from the associated article, it's unlikely that your teacher will ask you to use it in academic writing.



3. Descriptive abstract

A descriptive abstract gives a short description of the research proposal. It may include purpose, method, and the scope of the research, and it's often 100 words or less in length. Some people consider it to be an outline of the research proposal rather than an actual abstract for the document.

While a descriptive abstract describes the type of information a reader will find in a research proposal, it neither criticizes the work nor provides results and conclusion of the study.

4. Informative Abstract

Many abstracts in academic writing are informative. They don't analyze the study or investigation that you propose, but they explain a research project in a way that they can stand independently. In other words, an informative abstract gives an explanation for the main arguments, evidence, and significant results.

In addition to featuring purpose, method, and scope, an informative abstract also includes the results, conclusion, as well as the recommendation of the author. As for the length, an informative abstract should not be more than 300 words.

How to Write an Abstract for a Research Proposal

Of the four types of abstracts that we've discussed above, an informative abstract is what you'll need to write in your research proposal. Writing an abstract for a research proposal isn't difficult at all. You only need to know what to write and how to write it, and you're good to get started.

1. Write in Active Voice

First, use active voice when writing an abstract for your research proposal. However, this doesn't mean you should avoid passive voice entirely. If you find that some

sentences can't make sense unless with passive sentence construction, feel free to bend this rule somewhat.

Second, make sure your sentences are concise and complete. Refrain from using ambiguous words. Keep the language simple instead.



Lastly, never use present or future tense to write an abstract for a research proposal. You're reporting a study that you've already conducted and therefore writing in past tense makes the most sense.

2. Format

Your abstract should come immediately after the title page. Write in block format without paragraph indentations. The abstract should not be more than 300 words long and the page should not have a number. The word "Abstract" in your research proposal should be center aligned in the page, unless otherwise stated.

In addition to these formatting rules, the last sentence of your abstract should summarize the application to practice or the conclusions of your study. In the case where it seems appropriate, you might want follow this by statement that suggests a need for additional research.

3. Time to Write the Abstract

There are no hard rules on when to write an abstract for a research proposal. Some students choose to write the section first while others choose to write it last. We strongly recommend that you write the abstract last because it's a summary of the whole paper. You can also write it in the beginning if you've already outlined your draft and know what you want to talk about even before you start writing.

Your informative abstract is subject to frequent changes as you work on your paper, and that holds whether you write the section first or last. Be flexible and tweak this part of the assignment as necessary. Also, make sure you report statistical findings in parentheses.

4. Review

Read abstract to be sure the summary of the study agrees with what you've written in your proposal. As we mentioned earlier, this section is subject to change depending

on the direction your research takes. So make sure you identify and correct any anomalies if any.

Mistakes to Avoid When Writing an Abstract for Research Proposal



To wind up this guide, here are some of the most common mistakes that you should avoid when writing an abstract for your research proposal:

- Avoid giving a lengthy background
- Don't include citations to other people's work
- An abstract shouldn't include a table, figure, image, or any kind of illustration
- Don't include terms that are difficult to understand.

INTRODUCTION AND BACKGROUND

The introduction of a research proposal should be separate from the background. However, note that the background should be written before the introduction, in fact, just before the introduction.

BACKGROUND

While the findings of one's study form the foreground of his or her research, it is equally important to establish the background of one's study. A well-written background provides your study with a context and prompt the readers to read the rest of your paper. The background of the study establishes the context of the research. Usually, the background forms the first section of a research article/thesis and justifies the need for conducting the study and summarizes what the study aims to achieve.

The background has to provide the context of the study. It has to talk about the broader research area, what the current literature says about the research area, what are some of the gaps in existing studies, and how this led to the gap or need you intend to examine in your study. The background for a proposal has to provide a solid start and foundation to the proposal. Therefore, it helps to cite relevant literature and provide necessary statistics to show why your study is needed. Note however that the detailed literature review has to come later in the paper, after the introduction.

The author usually outlines the historical developments in the literature that led to the

current topic of research concisely. If the study is interdisciplinary, it should describe how different disciplines are connected and what aspects of each discipline will be studied.



Additionally, authors should briefly highlight the main developments of their research topic and identify the main gaps that need to be addressed. In other words, this section should give an overview of your study. The section should be organized as:

- **What is known about the broad topic?**
- **What are the gaps or missing links that need to be addressed?**
- **What is the significance of addressing those gaps?**
- **What are the rationale and hypothesis of your study?**

The background section, therefore, should provide general information about the topic of your research and emphasize the main aims of the study. One should ensure that you only discuss the main and relevant aspects of the studies that have led to your aims. Do not elaborate on them as this should be done in the literature review section. The background section should discuss your findings in a chronological manner to accentuate the progress in the field and the missing points that need to be addressed. The background should be written as a summary of your interpretation of previous research and what your study proposes to accomplish.

How to make the background engaging

As the background includes a lot of information, it can become a long drag, causing the readers to lose interest. To ensure that your background is engaging, you should try to build a story around the central theme of your research.

Ensure that the story adheres to the core idea and does not digress into a broad literature review. Each idea should lead to the next so that readers are able to grasp the story and themselves identify the gaps that your study is going to address.

How to avoid common mistakes in writing the background

While writing an effective background, you ought to steer clear of some mistakes. The most common mistakes in writing the background include the following:

Don't write a background that is too long or too short. Focus on including all the important details but write concisely.



Don't be ambiguous. Writing in a way that does not convey the message to the readers defeats the purpose of the background, so express yourself keeping in mind that the reader does not know your research intimately.

Don't discuss unrelated themes. Try and center your discussion around the pivotal aspects of your research topic i.e. highlight the gaps in the literature, state the novelty of the study, and the need to conduct the study.

Don't be disorganized. Not discussing the themes in a chronological manner can confuse the reader about the progress in the field, so try and organize your writing carefully.

Background significance

This is where you explain why your research is necessary and how it relates to established research in your field. Your work might complement existing research, strengthen it, or even challenge it—no matter how your work will “play with” other researchers' work, you need to express it in detail in your research proposal.

This is also the section where you clearly define the existing problems your research will address. By doing this, you're explaining why your work is necessary—in other words, this is where you answer the reader's “so what?”

In your background significance section, you'll also outline how you'll conduct your research. If necessary, note which related questions and issues you won't be covering in your research.

INTRODUCTION

Introduction is an initial pitch of an idea; it sets the scene and puts the research in context. The introduction, being the first part of your proposal, must provide a clear understanding of what you plan to do. A well-written introduction will help make a compelling case for your research proposal. The introduction should be designed to

create interest in the reader about the topic and proposal. It should convey to the reader, what you want to do, what necessitates the study and your passion for the topic.

To begin with, the introduction must set context for your research by mentioning what is known about the topic and what needs to be explored further. In the introduction, you can highlight how



your research will contribute to the existing knowledge in your field and to overall scientific development.

The introduction should also contain the hypothesis that led to the development of the research design. If hypothesis cannot be constructed, the line of inquiry to be used in the research must be indicated. You can come up with this hypothesis by asking yourself questions like:

What is the central research problem?

What is the topic of study related to that problem?

What methods should be used to analyze the research problem?

Why is this research important, what is its significance, and how will its outcomes affect the society on the whole?

The introduction has to present and discuss the research question, the specific aspect of the broader research area or topic you will be examining in your study. It has to talk about how you arrived at and why you have chosen to study this particular research question. You will have to provide the necessary rationale here because your proposal and study hinge on this. Then, you need to present and discuss the problem statement, which talks about the present state with regard to your research topic, the ideal state, and how your research will attempt to provide a solution to attain the ideal state.

Your introduction achieves a few goals:

- Introduces you to the topic
- States your problem statement and the questions your research aims to answer
- Provides context for your research.
- In a research proposal, an introduction can be a few paragraphs long. It should be concise, but don't feel like you need to cram all of your information into one paragraph.

- In some cases, you need to include an abstract and/or a table of contents in your research proposal. These are included just before the introduction.



PROBLEM STATEMENT IN RESEARCH

The statement of the problem is one of the first things that a colleague or potential client will read. With the vastness of the information available at one's fingertips in the online world, your work may have just a few seconds to draw in a reader to take a deeper look at your proposal before moving on to the next option. It explains quickly to the reader, the problem at hand, the need for research, and how you intend to do it.

A strong, clear description of the problem that drew you to your research has to be straightforward, easy to read and, most important, relevant. Why do you care about this problem? How can solving this problem impact the world? The problem statement is your opportunity to explain why you care and what you propose to do in the way of researching the problem.

What is a statement of the problem in research?

All research projects should start with a clear problem statement. A problem statement is a formulation of an issue which is usually a 'gap' within your area. A research gap is an unanswered question, an issue, controversy, or untested hypothesis that has not yet been addressed.

A problem statement is an explanation in research that describes the issue that is in need of study. What problem is the research attempting to address? Having a Problem Statement allows the reader to quickly understand the purpose and intent of the research. The importance of writing your research proposal cannot be stressed enough.

It is expected to be brief and concise, and should not include the findings of the research or detailed data. The average length of a research statement is generally about one page. It is going to define the problem, which can be thought of as a gap in the information base. There may be several solutions to this gap or lack of information, but that is not the concern of the problem statement. Its purpose is to summarize the

current information and where a lack of knowledge may be presenting a problem that needs to be investigated.

The purpose of the problem statement is to identify the issue that is a concern and focus it in a way that allows it to be studied in a systematic way. It defines the problem and proposes a way to research a solution, or demonstrates why further information is needed in order for a solution to become possible.



What is Included in a Problem Statement?

Besides identifying the gap of understanding or the weakness of necessary data, it is important to explain the significance of this lack.

- -How will your research contribute to the existing knowledge base in your field of study?
- -How is it significant?
- -Why does it matter?

Not all problems have only one solution so demonstrating the need for additional research can also be included in your problem statement. Once you identify the problem and the need for a solution, or for further study, then you can show how you intend to collect the needed data and present it.

How to write a problem statement in research?

Problem statements differ depending on the type and topic of research and vary between a few sentences to a few paragraphs.

However, the problem statement should not drag on needlessly. Despite the absence of a fixed format, a good research problem statement usually consists of three main parts:

Context: This section explains the background for your research. It identifies the problem and describes an ideal scenario that could exist in the absence of the problem. It also includes any past attempts and shortcomings at solving the problem.

Significance: This section defines how the problem prevents the ideal scenario from being achieved, including its negative impacts on the society or field of research. It should include who will be the most affected by a solution to the problem, the relevance of the study that you are proposing, and how it can contribute to the existing body of research.

Solution: This section describes the aim and objectives of your research, and your solution to overcome the problem. Finally, it need not focus on the perfect solution, but rather on addressing a realistic goal to move closer to the ideal scenario.

This will then directly lead to your proposed research objective and work plan and how that is expected to solve the problem i.e close the research gap.



Characteristics of a good problem statement

- It should be written clearly and in such a way that the reader's interest is captured immediately.
- The specific problem identified in the problem statement should be objectively researchable
- The scope of the specific research problem should be indicated
- The importance of the study in adding new knowledge should be stated clearly
- The problem statement must give the purpose of the research.

Writing a statement of the problem.

It is helpful to begin with your goal. What do you see as the achievable goal if the problem you outline is solved? How will the proposed research theoretically change anything? What are the potential outcomes?

Then you can discuss how the problem prevents the ability to reach your realistic and achievable solution. It is what stands in the way of changing an issue for the better. Talk about the present state of affairs and how the problem impacts a person's life, for example.

It's helpful at this point to generally layout the present knowledge and understanding of the subject at hand, before then describing the gaps of knowledge that are currently in need of study. Your problem statement is a proposed solution to address one of these gaps.

A good problem statement will also layout the repercussions of leaving the problem as it currently stands. What is the significance of not addressing this problem? What are the possible future outcomes?

Stating a research problem is done by defining it within the general area of your research. This depends on your previous work and experience. It may be an area you want to move into or a topic related to what you have already worked on as a researcher. Examples could include a question in astrophysics within physics, robotics

within engineering, nutrition within medicine, or marine biology within ocean and Earth science.

Once you've determined your overall area (and you'll know this already of course), it's time to drill down, decide, and define a research problem within that field.



First, your statement should identify a problem that needs to be addressed within your selected sub-area. This will almost certainly require literature work, but the idea may arise from discussions you've had with colleagues, discussions at a conference, a paper you've read.

Second, your problem statement should be a "good research problem." This will require further investigation and reading as you consider "what has been done?" and "what needs to be done?"

Third, search for more information, perhaps by locating relevant books, papers and other materials, evaluating the quality and authority of the information collected, maintaining a regular literature review throughout the project, making regular notes on background material, deciding how this literature search will be carried out within the research group, deciding how information gained will be disseminated to the group (e.g., via each researcher carrying out a regular literature review in their sub-area and information disseminated at group meetings or via email at regular intervals).

This process may well change or modify how your research problem is stated or formulated. Once your research problem has been identified, research questions within the problem need to be specified.

Your statement of the problem should not be too long. One page is more than enough for a clear and effective problem statement.

Research questions within your problem statement

In order to write a clear and useful problem statement, you need to describe a question and its consequences. One key way to assess the 'usefulness' of your research ideas is to learn how to express them as clear problems

The first stage of writing your research problem statement involves formulating your questions in a meaningful way. In the context of important questions, we are looking

for things that many readers across different disciplines find to be interesting. But at the same time, set your question within your field.

Thus, once a research problem has been established, several questions can be written down. These questions should specify exactly what needs to be determined to address the problem.



These questions should also be specific enough that they can be answered using appropriate available research methods - or methods that could be made available to the research group (e.g. by buying or borrowing equipment).

These questions should require complex in-depth investigation, analysis, and argument. They should not be simple enough that they can be answered easily with well-established facts or yes/no answers.

All research questions should be focused, specific, appropriately complex, and relevant to the overall aims of the project.

Examples of questions

How do government regulations prevent companies from polluting water systems? What factors have influenced population growth in the fastest growing countries?

How can a bespoke thermal desorption unit be designed and built for use in detection of trace particulate matter in a polluted environment (e.g a busy city street)?

What methods and procedures can be used to understand, and hence control, fundamental chemical processes that occur in flames?

How can measurement protocols used in mass spectrometry in a university research laboratory be developed and standardized to enable direct comparison with related measurements in a government laboratory?

Example of Problem Statement in Research Proposal

If, for example, you intended to research the effect of vitamin D supplementation on the immune system, you would begin with a review of the current knowledge of vitamin D's known function in relation to the immune system and how a deficiency of

it impacts a person's defenses.

You would describe the ideal environment in the body when there is a sufficient level of vitamin

D. Then, begin to identify the problems associated with vitamin D deficiency and the difficulty of raising the level through supplementation, along with the consequences of that deficiency. Here

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you are beginning to identify the problem of a common deficiency and the current difficulty of increasing the level of vitamin D in the blood.

At this stage, you may begin to identify the problem and narrow it down in a way that is practical to a research project. Perhaps you are proposing a novel way of introducing Vitamin D in a way that allows for better absorption by the gut, or in a combination with another product that increases its level in the blood.

Describe the way your research in this area will contribute to the knowledge base on how to increase levels of vitamin D in a specific group of subjects, perhaps menopausal women with breast cancer. The research proposal is then described in practical terms.

Conclusion

Defining and writing a clear statement of a problem as the basis of a project is the first and most important step in any research. A clear research problem statement will likely form the skeleton of the introduction of your final article. If you are able to clearly direct your reader to an important and interesting question, they will likely stay engaged, and use and cite your article in the future. Developing a 'good' research problem statement, therefore, involves systematic planning and setting time-based, realistic objectives. Your problem has to be achievable.

TOPIC: RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

INTRODUCTION

Research objectives describe concisely what the research is trying to achieve. They summarize the accomplishments a researcher wishes to achieve through the project and provides direction to the study.

1. Research is an organized investigation of a problem in which there is an attempt to gain solution to a problem.

2. To get right solution of a right problem, clearly defined objectives are very important.
3. Clearly defined objectives enlighten the way in which the researcher has to proceed.



MEANING

A research objective is a clear, concise, declarative statement, which provides direction to investigate the variables

Generally research objective focus on the ways to measure the variables, such as to identify or describe them.

Sometime objectives are directed towards identifying the relationship or difference between two variables.

Research objective are the results sought by the researcher at the end of the research process,

i.e. what the researcher will be able to achieve at the end of the research study.

1. The objectives of a research project summarize what is to be achieved by the study.
2. Objective should be closely related to the statement of the problem.

CHARACTERISTICS OF RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

1. Research objectives is a concrete statement describing what the research is trying to achieve.

A well-worded objective will be SMART, i.e Specific, Measurable, Attainable, Realistic, & Time- bound

2. Research objective should be Relevant, Feasible, Logical, Observable, Unequivocal and Measurable.
3. Objective is a purpose that can be reasonably achieved within the expected timeframe & with the available resources.
4. The objective or research project summarizes what is to be achieved by the study.
5. The research objectives are the specific accomplishment the researchers hope to achieve by the study.

6. The objective includes obtaining answers to research questions or testing the research hypothesis.



NEED OF RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

The formulation of research objectives helps the researcher to.....

1. With clearly defined objectives, the researchers can focus on the study.
2. The formulation of research objectives will help researcher to avoid the collection of data which are not strictly necessary for understanding & solving problem that he or she has defined.
3. Properly formulated, specific objectives will facilitate the development of research methodology & will help to orient the collection, analysis, interpretation, & utilization of data.

TYPES OF RESEARCH OBJECTIVES

1. General objective

General objectives provide a detailed view of the aim of a study.

- General objectives are broad goals to be achieved.
- The general objectives of the study state what the researcher expects to achieve by the study in general terms.
- General objectives are usually less in number.

2. Specific objective

Specific objectives define the primary aim of the study.

- Specific objectives are short term & narrow in focus.
- The specific objectives are more in number & they systematically address various aspects of problem as defined under 'the statement of problem' & key factor that is assumed to influence or causes the problem.
- They should specify what the researcher will do in the study, where, & for what

purpose.

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EXAMPLES OF GENERAL & SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES

Research statement: “Effectiveness of planned teaching on the knowledge of staff nurses working in psychiatric unit regarding Physical Restraints for psychiatric patient in selected hospital of mbarara region”.

General objective: To assess the knowledge of staff nurses working in psychiatric unit regarding physical restraint.

Specific objective:

1. To assess the knowledge regarding Physical Restraints among nurses working in psychiatric unit.
2. To evaluate the effect of planned teaching on Physical Restraints among nurses.
3. To associate the knowledge with selected demographic variables.

It should be noted that some parts of the objectives could be descriptive, some correlational and some explanatory. But as a matter of fact a good study combines all 3 of these objectives.

And I will summarize this in the table below:

Type of research	Main theme	Aim
Descriptive research	To describe what is prevalent	To describe what is prevalent regarding • Group of people • Community • A phenomenon • A situation • A programme • An outcome

Correlational research	To ascertain if there is a relationship	to establish or explore • A relationship • An association
		• An interdependence
Explanatory research	To explain why the relationship is formed	To explain • Why a relationship or interdependence exists • Why a particular event occurs • To develop, refine, and or test measurement tools and procedures.

METHODS OF STATING OBJECTIVES

While stating objectives of the study, the following guidelines must be taken care of:
The objectives should be presented briefly & concisely.

They cover the different aspects of the problem & its contributing factors in a coherent way & in a logical sequence.

The objectives are clearly phrased in operational terms, specifying exactly what researcher is going to do, where, & for what purpose.

They are realistic considering local conditions.

Use action verbs that are specify enough to be evaluated.

Examples of action verbs are: to assess, to identify, to find out, to determine, to

compare, to find, to verify, to calculate, to describe, to analyze, to establish, etc.

In conclusion, Well-defined objectives of research are an essential component of successful research engagement. If you want to drive all aspects of your research methodology such as data collection, design, analysis and recommendation, you need to lay down the objectives of research methodology. In other words, the objectives of research should address the underlying purpose of



investigation and analysis. It should outline the steps you'd take to achieve desirable outcomes and finally Research objectives help you stay focused and adjust your expectations as you progress.

TOPIC: RESEARCH QUESTIONS.

Research questions lie at the core of systematic investigation and this is because recording accurate research outcomes is tied to asking the right questions. Asking the right questions when conducting research can help you collect relevant and insightful information that ultimately influences your work, positively.

The right research questions are typically easy to understand, straight to the point, and engaging.

What is a Research Question?

A research question is a specific inquiry which the research seeks to provide a response to. It resides at the core of systematic investigation and it helps you to clearly define a path for the research process.

A research question is usually the first step in any research project. Basically, it is the primary interrogation point of your research and it sets the pace for your work.

Typically, a research question focuses on the research, determines the methodology and hypothesis, and guides all stages of inquiry, analysis, and reporting. With the right research questions, you will be able to gather useful information for your investigation.

Types of Research Questions

Research questions are broadly categorized into 2; that is, qualitative research

questions and quantitative research questions. [Qualitative and quantitative research questions](#) can be used independently and co-dependently in line with the overall focus and objectives of your research.

If your research aims at collecting [quantifiable data](#), you will need to make use of quantitative research questions. On the other hand, qualitative questions help you to gather [qualitative data](#) bothering on the perceptions and observations of your research subjects.



Qualitative Research Questions

A qualitative research question is a type of systematic inquiry that aims at collecting qualitative data from research subjects. The aim of qualitative research questions is to gather non-statistical information pertaining to the experiences, observations, and perceptions of the research subjects in line with the objectives of the investigation.

Types of Qualitative Research Questions

- **Ethnographic Research Questions**

Ethnographic research questions are inquiries presented in ethnographic research. [Ethnographic research](#) is a qualitative research approach that involves observing variables in their natural environments or habitats in order to arrive at objective research outcomes.

These research questions help the researcher to gather insights into the habits, dispositions, perceptions, and behaviors of research subjects as they interact in specific environments.

Ethnographic research questions can be used in education, business, medicine, and other fields of study, and they are very useful in contexts aimed at collecting in-depth and specific information that are peculiar to research variables. For instance, asking educational ethnographic research questions can help you understand how pedagogy affects classroom relations and behaviors.

This type of research question can be administered physically through one-on-one interviews, naturalism (live and work), and participant observation methods. Alternatively, the researcher can ask ethnographic research questions via online surveys and questionnaires created with Form plus.

Examples of Ethnographic Research Questions

1. Why do you use this product?
2. Have you noticed any side effects since you started using this drug?
3. Does this product meet your needs?



- **Case Studies**

A case study is a qualitative research approach that involves carrying out a detailed investigation into a research subject(s) or variable(s). In the course of a case study, the researcher gathers a range of data from multiple sources of information via different data collection methods, and over a period of time.

The aim of a case study is to analyze specific issues within definite contexts and arrive at detailed research subject analyses by asking the right questions. This research method can be explanatory, [descriptive](#), or [exploratory](#) depending on the focus of your systematic investigation or research.

Some questions you can include in your case studies are:

1. Why did you choose our services?
2. How has this policy affected your business output?
3. What benefits have you recorded since you started using our product?

- **Interviews**

An interview is a qualitative research method that involves asking respondents a series of questions in order to gather information about a research subject. Interview questions can be [close-ended](#) or [open-ended](#), and they prompt participants to provide valid information that is useful to the research.

An [interview may also be structured, semi-structured](#), or [unstructured](#), and this further influences the types of questions they include. Structured interviews are made up of more close-ended questions because they aim at gathering quantitative data while unstructured interviews consist, primarily, of open-ended questions that allow the researcher to collect qualitative information from respondents.

You can conduct interview research by scheduling a physical meeting with respondents, through a telephone conversation, and via digital media and video conferencing platforms like Skype and Zoom. Alternatively, you can use Formplus surveys and questionnaires for your interview.



Examples of interview questions include:

1. What challenges did you face while using our product?
2. What specific needs did our product meet?
3. What would you like us to improve our service delivery?

Quantitative Research Questions

Quantitative research questions are questions that are used to gather quantifiable data from research subjects. These types of research questions are usually more specific and direct because they aim at collecting information that can be measured; that is, statistical information.

Types of Quantitative Research Questions

- **Descriptive Research Questions**

Descriptive research questions are inquiries that researchers use to gather quantifiable data about the attributes and characteristics of research subjects. These types of questions primarily seek responses that reveal existing patterns in the nature of the research subjects.

It is important to note that [descriptive research](#) questions are not concerned with the causative factors of the discovered attributes and characteristics. Rather, they focus on the “what”; that is, describing the subject of the research without paying attention to the reasons for its occurrence.

Descriptive research questions are typically close-ended because they aim at gathering definite and specific responses from research participants. Also, they can be used in [customer experience surveys](#) and [market research](#) to collect information about target markets and consumer behaviors.

Descriptive Research Question Examples

1. How often do you make use of our fitness application?
2. How much would you be willing to pay for this product?



Comparative Research Questions

A comparative research question is a type of quantitative research question that is used to gather information about the differences between two or more research subjects across different variables. These types of questions help the researcher to identify distinct features that mark one research subject from the other while highlighting existing similarities.

Asking comparative research questions in [market research surveys](#) can provide insights on how your product or service matches its competitors. In addition, it can help you to identify the strengths and weaknesses of your product for a better competitive advantage.

Examples of Comparative Research Question

1. What are the differences between a landline telephone and a smartphone?
2. What are the differences between work-from-home and on-site operations?

- **Relationship-based Research Questions**

A relationship-based research question is one that inquiries into the nature of the association between two research subjects within the same demographic. These types of research questions help you to gather information pertaining to the nature of the association between two research variables.

Relationship-based research questions are also known as correlational research questions because they seek to clearly identify the link between 2 variables.

Examples of relationship-based research questions include:

1. What is the relationship between purchasing power and the business site?

2. What is the relationship between the work environment and workforce turnover?

So a good research question is one that requires impartial responses and can be answered via existing sources of information. Also, a good research question seeks answers that actively



contribute to a body of knowledge; hence, it is a question that is yet to be answered in your specific research context.

Open-Ended Questions

An [open-ended question](#) is a type of research question that does not restrict respondents to a set of premeditated answer options. In other words, it is a question that allows the respondent to freely express his or her perceptions and feelings towards the research subject.

Examples of Open-ended Questions

1. How do you deal with stress in the workplace?
2. What is a typical day at work like for you?

Close-ended Questions

A [close-ended question](#) is a type of survey question that restricts respondents to a set of predetermined answers such as [multiple-choice questions](#). Close-ended questions typically require yes or no answers and are commonly used in quantitative research to gather [numerical data](#) from research participants.

Examples of Close-ended Questions

- Did you enjoy this event?
 1. Yes
 2. No

Likert Scale Questions

A Likert scale question is a type of close-ended. This type of question is used to measure the survey respondent's disposition towards multiple variables and it can be unipolar or bipolar in nature.

Example of Likert Scale Questions

- How satisfied are you with our service delivery?



1. Very dissatisfied
2. Not satisfied
3. Neutral
4. Satisfied
5. Very satisfied

- **Rating Scale Questions**

A [rating scale](#) question is a type of close-ended question that seeks to associate a specific qualitative measure (rating) with the different variables in research. It is commonly used in customer experience surveys, market research surveys, employee reviews, and product evaluations.

Example of Rating Questions

- How would you rate our service delivery?
1. Excellent
 2. Good
 3. Neutral
 4. Bad
 5. Very bad

Examples of a Bad Research Question

- **Loaded Questions**

A loaded question is a question that subtly presupposes one or more unverified assumptions about the research subject or participant. This type of question typically boxes the respondent in a corner because it suggests implicit and explicit biases that prevent objective responses.

Example of Loaded Questions

1. Have you stopped smoking?



2. Where did you hide the money?

- **Negative Questions**

A negative question is a type of question that is structured with an implicit or explicit negator. Negative questions can be misleading because they upturn the typical yes/no response order by requiring a negative answer for affirmation and an affirmative answer for negation.

Examples of Negative Questions

1. Would you mind dropping by my office later today?
2. Didn't you visit last week?

- **Leading Questions**

A [leading question](#) is a type of survey question that nudges the respondent towards an already- determined answer. It is highly suggestive in nature and typically consists of biases and unverified assumptions that point towards its premeditated responses.

Examples of Leading Questions

1. If you enjoyed this service, would you be willing to try out our other packages?
2. Our product met your needs, didn't it?

Conclusion

The success of your research starts with framing the right questions to help you collect the most valid and objective responses. Be sure to avoid bad research questions like loaded and negative questions that can be misleading and adversely affect your research data and outcomes.

Your research questions should clearly reflect the aims and objectives of your systematic investigation while laying emphasis on specific contexts. To help you seamlessly gather responses for your research questions, and also you can create an online research questionnaire.



TOPIC: SIGNIFICANCE/ JUSTIFICATION.

- Research helps in the advancement of knowledge. It allows us to build on what we already know and to discover new things. This is especially important in fields such as medicine where advances in research can lead to new treatments and cures for diseases.
- Development of new technologies. Without research we wouldn't have many of the devices and products that we take for granted today such as computers, cellphones and medical treatments.
- Helps in problem solving. Whether its personal or professional it helps to look outside yourself for help. Therefore research helps to make informed plans and make informed decisions.
- Helps to give the latest information. It enables one to find the most recent information available in certain fields especially scientific one there is always new information and discoveries being made. Therefore with the latest information, you will be better equipped to talk about a subject and build on ideas.
- It builds one's credibility. People will take what you have to say more seriously when they can tell you are informed. Doing research gives one a solid foundation on which one can build his or her ideas and opinions i.e one can speak with confidence about what he or she knows is accurate.
- It encourages curiosity. Having curiosity and a love of learning takes you far in life. Research opens you up to different opinions and new ideas hence it also builds discerning and analytical skills.
- It helps to improve the quality of life for the members of the society. It is essential for informing the public about important issues like climate change, racial discriminating gender inequality and more and for developing new solutions to address pressing problems.
- It benefits business. Many successful industries like agriculture, food and

beverage, manufacturing, healthcare and pharmaceuticals, computer software have high research and development. Research therefore helps in the creation and improvement of their products and services.

In summary below are the importance of research.

- It discovers the unknown



- It builds the knowledge bases of the different disciplines
- It confirms phenomenon previously little known or tentative information
- It makes practice to be evidence based.
- It promotes professional accountability.
- It is an avenue for new ways of looking at things.

Conclusively, without research we would be reliant on outdated information and would be

unable to identify new opportunities for innovation. Therefore, it's essential in ensuring that we can continue to make progress as a society.

TOPIC: SCOPE OF THE STUDY.

What is the scope of the study?

The scope of the study explains the extent to which your research area will be explored, and the parameters the study will operate. It gives the reader and the writer an insight into what the study is aimed at and what should be anticipated.

This implies that the scope of the study should define the purpose of your study, the sample size and qualities, geographical location, the timeframe at which the study will be executed, theories the study will focus on, etc.

The scope of the study is just an aspect of research writing, and great attention needs to be taken not to go beyond what is expected. Therefore, the scope of the study sheds light on areas your study will cover and what it focuses on. What your study area is not going to focus on is of no relevance to your research study, and the scope of the study eliminates that.

Now that you understand the study's scope, how do you write one for your research work?

How to Write a Scope of Study

In writing the Scope of Study of research work, you need to include significant points that will guide your audiences (readers) and provide them with adequate information about the rationale and limits of your study.



To write your scope of the study, you need to restate the research problem and objectives of your study. You should state the period in which your study focuses on. The research methods utilized in your study should also be stated. This incorporates data such as sample size, geographical location, variables, and the method of analysis. You also need to state the academic theories applied to the data. This conveys to the reader the lens of analysis you are using. Collection of all data is impossible on a subject and exploration of all aspects of a subject. Therefore, all research is restricted in scope and subjected to limitations.

When writing your scope of the study, you need to note that if you broaden it too much, you may not be able to do justice to the study. That is, it may take a longer period to complete. Also, limiting your scope might limit your findings and make the research easier at your end. Before you define the scope of your work, you need to analyze the feasibility of your study.

For instance, if you are writing on the topic "The Impact of Anti-Corruption Agencies in Ugandan Election from 2006-2020", your scope will comprise all impacts (positive or negative) within the stated time frame. The anti-corruption agencies analyzed would also be included. Obtaining data for this time frame may also be tasking.

TIME SCOPE.

Definition: A period of time especially with respect to some action or project

While writing the scope of the study the researcher should first mention or state categorically

the time periods the study will cover. Generally, the researchers combine the scope of the study

with the limitation of the study. These things are quite interwoven. The main difference

between the two is that limitations further cover the points like monetary

constraints or non-

cooperation from the side of the target audience.

As a researcher, you have to be careful when you define your scope or area of focus. Remember that if you broaden the scope too much, you might not be able to do justice to the work or it might take a very long time to complete. Consider the feasibility of your work before you write down the scope. Again, if the scope is too narrow, the findings might not be generalizable.



Choosing a specific timeframe for your research can result in more precise findings than working with an open-ended timeframe. Also, deciding whether you will repeat this research at regular intervals will allow you to set up data collection benchmarks for easy replication and comparison over time.

The time scope can also guide on which methodology to use. As a general rule, the more in-depth the method the more time consuming it is. Also, doing your own primary research tends to take longer than using secondary sources.

CONTENT SCOPE.

Definition; it is the description of the breadth and depth of the record group, collection, or archival materials.

It indicates the extent to which the research area will be explored in the project. Basically it identifies the depth of your study and the parameters within which the study will be operating. To this end, you will have to define what the study is going to cover and what it is focusing on.

Similarly you also have to define what the study is not going to cover and this will be discussed under the limitation of the study.

So the scope of a research paper is followed by its limitations. Your scope and delimitations are the sections where you define the broader parameters and boundaries of your research.

The scope details what your study will explore such as the target population, extent or study duration.

Delimitations are factors and variables not included in the study. Basically this means that you will have to define what the study is going to cover and what it is focusing on.

GEOGRAPHICAL SCOPE.

This means the area covered by a model or analysis used to calculate physical changes resulting from a proposed project.

The geographical scope of a document can help in retrieving documents by improving geographical restriction on the search query and can also be used in the toponym resolution task.



So it enables us to have a better understanding of physical things around us such as vegetation, climate, and population among others.

METHODS/METHODOLOGY

- **Literature review**
- **Theoretical framework**
- **Referencing**
- **Footnoting; specific attention to OSCOLA referencing (4th edition)**
- **Topic: methods/methodology.**

The methodology chapter explains what you did it allowing readers to evaluate the reliability and validity of your research. Your research methodology discusses and explains the data collection and analysis methods you used in your research. A key part of your thesis, dissertation, or research paper, the methodology chapter explains what you did and how you did it, allowing readers to evaluate the reliability and validity of your research.

It should include:

- 1. The type of research you conducted**
- 2. How you collected and analysed your data**
- 3. Any tools or materials you used in the research**
- 4. Why you chose these methods**
- 5. Your methodology section should generally be written in the past tense.**
- 6. Step 1: Explain your methodological**

**approach Tips for writing a strong
methodology chapter**

Remember that your aim is not just to describe your methods, but to show how and why you applied them. Again, it's critical to demonstrate that your research was

rigorously conducted and can be replicated.

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1. Focus on your objectives and research questions

The methodology section should clearly show why your methods suit your objectives and convince the reader that you chose the best possible approach to answering your problem statement and research questions.

2. Cite relevant sources

Your methodology can be strengthened by referencing existing research in your field. This can help you to:

Show that you followed established practice for your type of research
Discuss how you decided on your approach by evaluating existing research
Present a novel methodological approach to address a gap in the literature

3. Write for your audience

Consider how much information you need to give, and avoid getting too lengthy. If you are using methods that are standard for your discipline, you probably don't need to give a lot of background or justification.

Regardless, your methodology should be a clear, well-structured text that makes an argument for your approach, not just a list of technical details and procedures

Before you start writing, we always recommend that you draw up a rough outline, so that you have a clear direction to head in. Don't just start writing without knowing what will go where. If you do, you'll most likely end up with a disjointed, poorly flowing narrative. As a result, you'll waste a lot of time rewriting in an attempt to try to stitch all the pieces together. Start with the end in mind. The contents of the research methodology chapter are discussed below;

Introduction: As with all chapters in your dissertation or thesis, the methodology chapter should have a brief introduction. In this introduction, you should remind your readers what the focus of your study is, especially the research aims and you always know that your research design needs to align with your research aims, objectives and research questions, so it's useful to frontload this to remind the reader (and yourself!) what you're trying to achieve with your design and



methodology. In this section, you can also briefly mention how you'll structure the chapter. This will help orient the reader and provide a bit of a roadmap so that they know what to expect.

The Research Design: The next section of your methodology chapter should present your research design to the reader. In this section, you need to detail and justify all the key design choices in a logical, intuitive fashion. This is the heart of your methodology chapter, so you need to get specific – don't hold back on the details here. This is not one of those “less is more” situations.

The Methodological Limitations: With the key research design choices outlined and justified, the next step is to discuss the limitations of your design. No research design or methodology is perfect – there will always be trade-offs between the “ideal” design and what's practical and viable, given your constraints. Therefore, this section of your methodology chapter is where you'll discuss the trade-offs you had to make, and why these were justified given the context.

Methodological limitations can vary greatly from study to study, ranging from common issues such as time and budget constraints to issues of sample or selection bias. For example, you may find that you didn't manage to draw in enough respondents to achieve the desired sample size (and therefore, statistically significant results), or your sample may be skewed heavily towards a certain demographic, thereby negatively impacting representativeness.

In this section, it's important to be critical of the shortcomings of your study. There's no use trying to hide them (your marker will be aware of them regardless). By being critical, you'll demonstrate to your marker that you have a strong understanding of research design, so don't be shy here. At the same time, don't beat your study to death. State the limitations, why these were justified, how you mitigated their impacts to the best degree possible, and how your study still provides value despite these limitations.

Concluding Summary:

Finally, it's time to wrap up the methodology chapter with a brief concluding summary. In this section, you'll want to concisely summarise what you've presented in the chapter. Here, it can be useful to use a figure to summarise the key design decisions, especially if your university recommends using a specific model. Importantly, this section needs to be brief – a paragraph or two maximum (it's a summary, after all). Also, make sure that when you write up your concluding



summary, you include only what you've already discussed in your chapter; don't add any new information.

The exact contents and structure of this chapter can vary between universities, so be sure to check in with your institution before you start writing. If possible, try to find dissertations or theses from former students of your specific degree program – this will give you a strong indication of the expectations and norms when it comes to the methodology chapter (and all the other chapters!).

Also, remember the golden rule of the methodology chapter – justify every choice! Make sure that you clearly explain the “why” for every “what”, and reference credible methodology textbooks or academic sources to back up your justifications.

Advantages of the methodology chapter in research

The methodology chapter is important for two reasons:

Firstly, it demonstrates your understanding of research design theory, which is what earns you marks. A flawed research design or methodology would mean flawed results, so this chapter is vital as it allows you to show the marker that you know what you're doing and that your results are credible.

Secondly, the methodology chapter is what helps to make your study replicable – in other words, it allows other researchers to undertake your study using the same design, and compare their findings to yours. This is very important within academic research, as each study builds on previous studies.

The methodology chapter is also important because it allows you to identify and discuss any methodological issues or problems you encountered (i.e. limitations), and to explain how you mitigated the impacts of these. Every research project has its limitations and shortcomings, so it's important to acknowledge these openly and highlight your study's value despite its limitations. Again, this demonstrates your

understanding of research design, which will earn you marks. We'll discuss limitations in more detail later in this post



Topic: Literature review.

A literature review is a comprehensive summary of previous research on a topic. It surveys scholarly articles, books and other sources relevant to a particular area of research. The review should enumerate, describe, summarize, objectively evaluate and clarify the previous research.

A “review of the literature” is a classification and evaluation of what accredited scholars and researchers have written on a topic. Occasionally you will be asked to write one as a separate assignment, but often it is part of the introduction to an essay, research report, or thesis. In writing the literature review, your purpose is to convey to your reader what knowledge and ideas have been established on a topic, and what their strengths and weaknesses are. As a piece of writing, the literature review must be defined by a guiding concept (e.g., your research objective, the problem or issue you are exploring, or your thesis). It is not just a descriptive list of the material available, or a set of summaries.

A literature review consists of an overview, a summary, and an evaluation (“critique”) of the current state of knowledge about a specific area of research. It may also include a discussion of methodological issues and suggestions for future research. Besides enlarging your knowledge about the topic, writing a literature review lets you gain and demonstrate skills in two areas:

1. information seeking: the ability to scan the literature efficiently, using manual and computerized methods, to identify a set of useful articles, books and documents;
2. critical appraisal: the ability to apply principles of analysis to identify unbiased and valid studies.

Both undergraduate and graduate students face similar challenges when tasked with writing literature reviews. Breaking down the literature review into a four-part process helps students decrease frustration and increase quality. This article provides usable advice for anyone teaching or writing literature reviews. Tips and illustrations

illuminate each part of the process, including

- 1) Developing a Topic;
- 2) Searching the Literature;
- 3) Narrowing the Scope; and
- 4) Synthesizing Prior Research.



First, practical tips for topic development include welcoming change and exercises for allowing students to “talk out” topic evolution in physical or virtual settings. Next, tips for searching include defining quality research in the discipline, linking to online tools, refining language, and working with that first good article. Then, practical tips for narrowing include advice for deconstructing articles and questions to ask when “talking out” refinement of the project. Finally, practical tips for synthesizing include virtual tagging and physical clustering exercises.

What Makes a Good Literature Review/ contents of a good literature review

The contents of a literature review are determined by many factors, including its precise purpose in the article, the degree of consensus with a given theory or tension between competing theories, the length of the article, the number of previous studies existing in the given field, etc. The following are some of the most important elements that a literature review provides.

Historical background for your research: Analyze what has been written about your field of research to highlight what is new and significant in your study—or how the analysis itself contributes to the understanding of this field, even in a small way. Providing a historical background also demonstrates to other researchers and journal editors your competency in discussing theoretical concepts. You should also make sure to understand how to paraphrase scientific literature to avoid plagiarism in your work.

The current context of your research: Discuss central (or peripheral) questions, issues, and debates in the field. Because a field is constantly being updated by new work, you can show where your research fits into this context and explain developments and trends in research.

A discussion of relevant theories and concepts: Theories and concepts should provide the foundation for your research. For example, if you are researching the

relationship between ecological environments and human populations, provide models and theories that focus on specific aspects of this connection to contextualize your study. If your study asks a question concerning sustainability, mention a theory or model that underpins this concept. If it concerns invasive species, choose material that is focused in this direction.

Definitions of relevant terminology: In the natural sciences, the meaning of terms is relatively straightforward and consistent. But if you present a term that is obscure or context-specific, you



should define the meaning of the term in the Introduction section (if you are introducing a study) or in the summary of the literature being reviewed.

Description of related relevant research: Include a description of related research that shows how your work expands or challenges earlier studies or fills in gaps in previous work. You can use your literature review as evidence of what works, what doesn't, and what is missing in the field. Supporting evidence for a practical problem or issue your research is addressing that demonstrates its importance: Referencing related research establishes your area of research as reputable and shows you are building upon previous work that other researchers have deemed significant.

A literature review must;

Be organized around and related directly to the thesis or research question you are developing; synthesize results into a summary of what is and is not known;

identify areas of controversy in the literature;

formulate questions that need further research. **Why are Literature Reviews**

Important?

To become an expert in any field of endeavour, you must know your field comprehensively. Critical reviews of state-of-the-art literature permit the professional to make informed decisions, to act in an expert manner, and to set policy in his or her field of expertise.

Researchers conduct reviews of the literature to justify proposed studies, to uncover patterns of findings in the field, to enter into scientific debate, and to discover gaps in knowledge that lead to future research questions. Research reviews are often the first step toward making discoveries and social interventions in our society.

Disadvantages of literature review

Time consuming: As a literature review involves collecting and evaluating research

and summarizing the findings, it requires a significant amount of time. To conduct a comprehensive review, researchers need to read many different articles and analyse a lot of data. This means that their review will take a long time to complete.

Lack of quality sources: Researchers are expected to use a wide variety of sources of information to present a comprehensive review. However, it may sometimes be challenging for them to identify the quality sources because of the availability of huge numbers in their chosen field. It may also



happen because of the lack of past empirical work, particularly if the selected topic is an unpopular one.

Descriptive writing: One of the major disadvantages of literature review is that instead of critical appreciation, some researchers end up developing reviews that are mostly descriptive. Their reviews are often more like summaries of the work of other writers and lack in criticality. It is worth noting that they must go beyond describing the literature.

Types of literature review

There are many types of literature review. The choice of a specific type depends on your research approach and design. The following types of literature review are the most popular in business studies:

Narrative literature review, also referred to as traditional literature review, critiques literature and summarizes the body of a literature. Narrative review also draws conclusions about the topic and identifies gaps or inconsistencies in a body of knowledge. You need to have a sufficiently focused research question to conduct a narrative literature review

Systematic literature review requires more rigorous and well-defined approach compared to most other types of literature review. Systematic literature review is comprehensive and details the timeframe within which the literature was selected. Systematic literature review can be divided into two categories: meta-analysis and meta-synthesis. When you conduct meta-analysis you take findings from several studies on the same subject and analyze these using standardized statistical procedures. In meta-analysis patterns and relationships are detected and conclusions are drawn. Meta-analysis is associated with deductive research approach.

Meta-synthesis, on the other hand, is based on non-statistical techniques. This technique integrates, evaluates and interprets findings of multiple qualitative research

studies. Meta- synthesis literature review is conducted usually when following inductive research approach.

Scoping literature review, as implied by its name is used to identify the scope or coverage of a body of literature on a given topic. It has been noted that “scoping reviews are useful for examining emerging evidence when it is still unclear what other, more specific questions can be posed and valuably addressed by a more precise systematic review.”[1] The main difference between



systematic and scoping types of literature review is that, systematic literature review is conducted to find answer to more specific research questions, whereas scoping literature review is conducted to explore more general research question.

Argumentative literature review, as the name implies, examines literature selectively in order to support or refute an argument, deeply imbedded assumption, or philosophical problem already established in the literature. It should be noted that a potential for bias is a major shortcoming associated with argumentative literature review.

Integrative literature review reviews, critiques, and synthesizes secondary data about research topic in an integrated way such that new frameworks and perspectives on the topic are generated. If your research does not involve primary data collection and data analysis, then using integrative literature review will be your only option.

Theoretical literature review focuses on a pool of theory that has accumulated in regard to an issue, concept, theory, phenomena. Theoretical literature reviews play an instrumental role in establishing what theories already exist, the relationships between them, to what degree existing theories have been investigated, and to develop new hypotheses to be tested.

It should also be noted that at the earlier parts of the literature review chapter, you need to specify the type of your literature review you chose and justify your choice. Your choice of a specific type of literature review should be based upon your research area, research problem and research methods. Also, you can briefly discuss other most popular types of literature review mentioned above, to illustrate your awareness of them.

Questions to Ask Yourself About Your Review of Literature

Do I have a specific thesis, problem, or research question which my literature review helps to define?

What type of literature review am I conducting? Am I looking at issues of theory? methodology? policy? quantitative research (e.g., studies of neural pathways)? qualitative research (e.g., studies of loneliness among migrant workers)?

What is the scope of my literature review? What types of publications am I using (e.g., journals, books, government documents, popular media)? What disciplinary databases am



I searching? (e.g., nursing, psychology, sociology, medicine)?

How good are my information-seeking skills? Has my search been wide enough to ensure

I've found all the relevant material? Has it been narrow enough to exclude irrelevant material? Is the number of sources I've used appropriate for the length of my paper?

Is there a specific relationship between the literature I've chosen to review and the problem I've formulated?

Have I critically analyzed the literature I use? Do I just list and summarize authors and articles, or do I assess them? Do I discuss the strengths and weaknesses of the material I cite?

Have I cited and discussed studies contrary to my perspective?

Will the reader find my literature review relevant, appropriate, and useful?

Questions to Ask Yourself About each Book or Article You're Reviewing

1. Has the author formulated a problem/issue?
2. Is the problem/issue ambiguous or clearly articulated? Is its significance (scope, severity, relevance) discussed?
3. What are the strengths and limitations of the way the author has formulated the problem or issue?
4. Could the problem have been approached more effectively from another perspective?
5. What is the author's research orientation (e.g., interpretive, critical science, combination)?
6. What is the author's theoretical framework (e.g., psychoanalytic, developmental, feminist)?
7. What is the relationship between the theoretical and research perspectives? Has the author
8. evaluated the literature relevant to the problem/issue? Does the author include

literature taking positions s/he does not agree with?

9. In a research study, how good are the three basic components of the study design (i.e., population, intervention, outcome)? How accurate and valid are the measurements? Is the analysis of the data accurate and relevant to the research question? Are the conclusions validly based upon the data and analysis?



10. In popular literature, does the author use appeals to emotion, one-sided examples, rhetorically-charged language and tone? Is the author objective, or is s/he merely “proving” what s/he already believes?
11. How does the author structure his or her argument? Can you “deconstruct” the flow of the argument to analyze if/where it breaks down?
12. Is this a book or article that contributes to our understanding of the problem under study, and in what ways is it useful for theory or practice? What are its strengths and limitations?
13. How does this book or article fit into the thesis or question I am developing?

The Dos and Dents of a good literature

review Dents

A literature review does not simply reference and list all of the material you have cited in your paper.

Presenting material that is not directly relevant to your study will distract and frustrate the reader and make them lose sight of the purpose of your study.

Starting a literature review with “A number of scholars have studied the relationship between X and Y” and simply listing who has studied the topic and what each scholar concluded is not going to strengthen your paper.

Dos

Present a brief typology that orders articles and books into groups to help readers focus on unresolved debates, inconsistencies, tensions, and new questions about a research topic.

Summarize the most relevant and important aspects of the scientific literature related to your area of research

Synthesize what has been done in this area of research and by whom, highlight what previous research indicates about a topic, and identify potential gaps and areas of disagreement in the field

Give the reader an understanding of the background of the field and show which studies are important—and highlight errors in previous studies and give your own ideas to them.



Here are some steps that will help you begin and follow through on your literature review. Step 1: Choose a topic to write about—focus on and explore this topic

Choose a topic that you are familiar with and highly interested in analyzing; a topic your intended readers and researchers will find interesting and useful; and a topic that is current, well-established in the field, and about which there has been sufficient research conducted for a review. This will help you find the “sweet spot” for what to focus on.

Step 2: Research and collect all the scholarly information on the topic that might be pertinent to your study.

This includes scholarly articles, books, conventions, conferences, dissertations, and theses—these and any other academic work related to your area of study is called “the literature.”

Step 3: Analyze the network of information that extends or responds to the major works in your area; select the material that is most useful.

Use thought maps and charts to identify intersections in the research and to outline important categories; select the material that will be most useful to your review.

Step 4: Describe and summarize each article—provide the essential information of the article that pertains to your study.

Determine 2-3 important concepts (depending on the length of your article) that are discussed in the literature; take notes about all of the important aspects of this study relevant to the topic being reviewed.

For example, in a given study, perhaps some of the main concepts are X, Y, and Z. Note these concepts and then write a brief summary about how the article

incorporates them. In reviews that introduce a study, these can be relatively short. In stand-alone reviews, there may be significantly more texts and more concepts.

Step 5: Demonstrate how these concepts in the literature relate to what you discovered in your study or how the literature connects the concepts or topics being discussed.



In a literature review intro for an article, this information might include a summary of the results or methods of previous studies that correspond to and/or confirm those sections in your own study. For a stand-alone literature review, this may mean highlighting the concepts in each article and showing how they strengthen a hypothesis or show a pattern. Discuss unaddressed issues in previous studies. These studies that are missing something you address are important to include in your literature review. In addition, those works whose theories and conclusions directly support your findings will be valuable to review here.

Step 6: Identify relationships in the literature and develop and connect your own ideas to them.

This is essentially the same as step 5 but focused on the connections between the literature and the current study or guiding concepts or arguments of the paper, not only on the connections between the works themselves. Your hypothesis, argument, or guiding concept is the “golden thread” that will ultimately tie the works together and provide readers with specific insights they didn’t have before reading your literature review. Make sure you know where to put the research question, hypothesis, or statement of the problem in your research paper so that you guide your readers logically and naturally from your introduction of earlier work and evidence to the conclusions you want them to draw from the bigger picture.

Your literature review will not only cover publications on your topics but will include your own ideas and contributions. By following these steps you will be telling the specific story that sets the background and shows the significance of your research and you can turn a network of related works into a focused review of the your research readers.

Topic: Theoretical framework

A Theoretical framework is a fundamental review of existing theories that serves as a

roadmap for developing the arguments one can use in his or her work.

Theories are developed by researchers to explain phenomena, draw connections and make predictions. In a theoretical framework, you can explain the existing theories that support your research, showing that the dissertation topic is relevant and grounded in established ideas. In otherwards, the theoretical framework justifies and contextualizes your later research and it's a crucial first step for the research paper.



Theories are formulated to explain, predict, and understand phenomena and, in many cases, to challenge and extend existing knowledge, within the limits of the critical bounding assumptions. The theoretical framework is the structure that can hold or support a theory of a research study. The theoretical framework introduces and describes the theory which explains why the research problem under study exists. A theoretical framework consists of concepts, together with their definitions, and existing theory/theories that are used for your particular study. The theoretical framework must demonstrate an understanding of theories and concepts that are relevant to the topic of your research paper and that will relate it to the broader fields of knowledge in the class you are taking.

The theoretical framework is not something that is found readily available in the literature. You must review course readings and pertinent research literature for theories and analytic models that are relevant to the research problem you are investigating. The selection of a theory should depend on its appropriateness, ease of application, and explanatory power.

The theoretical framework strengthens the study in the following ways.

An explicit statement of theoretical assumptions permits the reader to evaluate them critically.

The theoretical framework connects the researcher to existing knowledge. Guided by a relevant theory, you are given a basis for your hypotheses and choice of research methods.

Articulating the theoretical assumptions of a research study forces you to address questions of why and how. It permits you to move from simply describing a phenomenon observed to generalizing about various aspects of that phenomenon.

Having a theory helps you to identify the limits to those generalizations. A theoretical framework specifies which key variables influence a phenomenon of interest. It alerts

you to examine how those key variables might differ and under what circumstances.

By virtue of its application nature, good theory in the social sciences is of value precisely because it fulfills one primary purpose: to explain the meaning, nature, and challenges of a phenomenon, often experienced but unexplained in the world in which we live, so that we may use that knowledge and understanding to act in more informed and effective ways.



Developing the Framework

Here are some strategies to develop of an effective theoretical framework:

Examine your thesis title and research problem. The research problem anchors your entire study and forms the basis from which you construct your theoretical framework.

Brainstorm on what you consider to be the key variables in your research. Answer the question, what factors contribute to the presumed effect?

Review related literature to find answers to your research question.

List the constructs and variables that might be relevant to your study. Group these variables into independent and dependent categories.

Review the key social science theories that are introduced to you in your course readings and choose the theory or theories that can best explain the relationships between the key variables in your study.

Discuss the assumptions or propositions of this theory and point out their relevance to your research.

A theoretical framework is used to limit the scope of the relevant data by focusing on specific variables and defining the specific viewpoint (framework) that the researcher will take in analyzing and interpreting the data to be gathered, understanding concepts and variables according to the given definitions, and building knowledge by validating or challenging theoretical assumptions.

Think of theories as the conceptual basis for understanding, analyzing, and designing ways to investigate relationships within social systems. To the end, the following roles served by a theory can help guide the development of your framework.*

Means by which new research data can be interpreted and coded for future

use, Response to new problems that have no previously identified solutions

strategy, Means for identifying and defining research problems,

Means for prescribing or evaluating solutions to research problems,



Way of telling us that certain facts among the accumulated knowledge are important and which facts are not,

Means of giving old data new interpretations and new meaning,

Means by which to identify important new issues and prescribe the most critical research questions that need to be answered to maximize understanding of the issue,

Means of providing members of a professional discipline with a common language and a frame of reference for defining boundaries of their profession, and

Means to guide and inform research so that it can, in turn, guide research efforts and improve professional practice.

The theoretical framework may be rooted in a specific theory, in which case, you are expected to test the validity of an existing theory in relation to specific events, issues, or phenomena. Many social science research papers fit into this rubric. For example, Peripheral Realism theory, which categorizes perceived differences between nation-states as those that give orders, those that obey, and those that rebel, could be used as a means for understanding conflicted relationships among countries in Africa. A test of this theory could be the following: Does Peripheral Realism theory help explain intra-state actions, such as, the growing split between southern and northern Sudan that may likely lead to the creation of two nations?

However, you may not always be asked by your professor to test a specific theory in your paper, but to develop your own framework from which your analysis of the research problem is derived. Given this, it is perhaps easiest to understand the nature and function of a theoretical framework if it is viewed as the answer to two basic questions:

What is the research problem/question? [e.g., "How should the individual and the state relate during periods of conflict?"]

Why is your approach a feasible solution? [I could choose to test Instrumentalist or Circumstantialists models developed among Ethnic Conflict Theorists that rely upon socio- economic-political factors to explain individual-state relations and to apply this theoretical model to periods of war between nations].



The answers to these questions come from a thorough review of the literature and your course readings [summarized and analyzed in the next section of your paper] and the gaps in the research that emerge from the review process. With this in mind, a complete theoretical framework will likely not emerge until after you have completed a thorough review of the literature.

In writing this part of your research paper, keep in mind the following:

Clearly describe the framework, concepts, models, or specific theories that underpin your study. This includes noting who the key theorists are in the field who have conducted research on the problem you are investigating and, when necessary, the historical context that supports the formulation of that theory. This latter element is particularly important if the theory is relatively unknown or it is borrowed from another discipline.

Position your theoretical framework within a broader context of related frameworks, concepts, models, or theories. There will likely be several concepts, theories, or models that can be used to help develop a framework for understanding the research problem. Therefore, note why the framework you've chosen is the appropriate one.

The present tense is used when writing about theory.

You should make your theoretical assumptions as explicit as possible. Later, your discussion of methodology should be linked back to this theoretical framework.

Don't just take what the theory says as a given! Reality is never accurately represented in such a simplistic way; if you imply that it can be, you fundamentally distort a reader's ability to understand the findings that emerge. Given this, always note the limitations of the theoretical framework you've chosen [i.e., what parts of the research problem require further investigation because the theory does not explain a certain phenomena].

Theories from different fields should be combined to build a unique framework.
Important theories should be briefly mentioned related to key concepts.



Topic: Referencing.

Referencing means acknowledging your sources in the body of your work and linking your citations to your list of words cited. In general, a reference will include authors names and initials, the title of the article ,name of the journal,volu volume and issue,data page numbers and DOI.

Referencing takes place in two

ways; In text citation

End text citation.

The in text citation is a brief reference in the body of the text and end text citations are the full reference which are found at the end of the document, in the form of a list. In text citation is an abbreviated reference we include within the main body of a paper. An in text citation usually involves the source of a paraphrase, quote, chart, image, video, or table. In simple words, writers use in text citations to show that a particular piece of information is extracted from an external source. This practice gives credit to the original author of that idea or argument and also helps to avoid plagiarism. An in text citation generally comes inside a set of parentheses. In an in text citation, we usually mention the last name of the author and the year of publication. Sometimes, we mention the page number, especially if it is a direct extraction.

These are also called parenthetical references. In text citations are short notations within a scholarly work and direct the reader to the references at the end of the paper, which provide the reader with the complete notions of the source. Therefore, all authors or publications cited as in text citations must be included in the list of references.

End text citation / reference is a list of complete citations. Generally, it includes the complete details of all the sources cited within a scholarly work. These include the

author's name, the title of the book or article, year of publication, publisher, page number, etc. The writer usually presents a reference list alphabetically. A reference generally starts with the name of the author. Given below is an example of an academic text in APA style

Referencing styles



There are four widely-used referencing styles or conventions. They are called the MLA (Modern Languages Association) system, the APA (American Psychological Association) system, the Harvard system, and the MHRA (Modern Humanities Research Association) system.

If you are producing essays for a particular institution or even a particular department make sure you know what system it is using. Your tutors may specify one of the four listed above or they may use another one entirely. Some departments will produce sheets explaining which system they want you to use.

The MLA system is a parenthetical system: i.e. bracketed references in the body of your essay are linked to full length citations in the bibliography at the end of your essay. The bracket in the body of the essay contains only the author's surname and the page number or numbers you are referring to. For example: There are a number of different referencing styles or conventions but there are four that are used most widely. (Kennedy, 17).

If your essay quotes from two or more works by the same author then the bracketed reference should include a shortened version of the title to indicate which book is being referred to. (Kennedy, *New Relations*, 26). A bibliography compiled according to MLA conventions lists items alphabetically by the author's last name. Each entry should include, in the following order: the author's name in full, the title of the book, the place of publication, the publisher, and the date. For example: Kennedy, David. *New Relations: The Refashioning of British Poetry 1980-1994*. Bridgend: Seren, 1996. Pay attention to how the entry is punctuated as that is part of the system too.

The APA system is also a parenthetical system but the bracketed references in the body of your essay are: the author's surname, the date of publication and the page or page numbers you are referring to. For example: There are a number of different referencing styles or conventions but there are four that are used most widely (Kennedy, 2003, p. 17). The reference always goes at the end of the sentence before

the full stop. A bibliography compiled according to APA conventions lists items alphabetically by the author's last name. Each entry should include, in the following order: the author's surname, their first initial, the date of publication in brackets, the title of the book, the place of publication and the publisher. For example: Kennedy, D. (1996) *New Relations*:



The Refashioning of British Poetry 1980-1994. Bridgend: Seren. Again, pay attention to how the entry is punctuated as that is part of the system too.

The Harvard system is another parenthetical system and the bracketed references in the body of your essay are: the author's surname and the date of publication. The list of works at the end of the essay is headed 'References'. The works listed in it appear in alphabetical order by the author's surname and follow the same format as the APA system.

The MHRA system does not use bracketed references in the body of an essay. Instead, superscript numbers like this ¹ are linked to a sequence of notes which appear either at the foot of the page or in a section at the end of your essay. The note contains the full reference for the book or article you are referring to. Here's what an MHRA note reference looks like:

1 David Kennedy, *New Relations: The Refashioning of British Poetry 1980-1994*. (Bridgend: Seren, 1996), p.26.

Advantages

Referencing works to give credit to sources and acknowledge the ideas, words and images that are not your own.

Referencing is one of the most important aspects of any academic research and poor or lack of referencing may be perceived as plagiarism. It also helps you avoid plagiarism, which is when you copy someone else's work and pass it off as your own.

It also helps readers to understand what influenced the writers thinking.

The disadvantage

Referencing can be time-consuming and tedious. If you're not careful, citing can become confusing. You may also have to pay if you use a resource that is copyrighted

or otherwise restricted-access information on the internet

Footnote.

A footnote is a note of reference explanation or comment usually placed below the text on a printed page.



The footnote might consist of the type of work and author's name along with other information related to the type of citation.

OSCOLA (the Oxford University Standard for the Citation of Legal Authorities) is a way of citing and referencing legal materials.

OSCOLA is a footnote referencing style. That means that you have small superscript numbers in your text (e.g. 1, 2, 3, etc.) and these link to footnotes at the bottom of each page. For longer documents, you may be asked* to include a list of abbreviations and tables of cases, legislation and other primary sources at the start, and a bibliography of secondary sources at the end. This is in addition to your footnotes.

How to use oscola referencing in the different sources of research.

Primary Sources: Do not use full stops in abbreviations. Separate citations with a semi-colon.

Cases

